

Consumer Perceptions of Product Placement within the United Kingdom's Entertainment Industry

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Dissertation submitted to Oxford Brookes University for the partial
fulfilment of the requirement for the degree of
MASTER OF SCIENCE IN MARKETING AND BRAND MANAGEMENT

September 2020

Word Count: 19,334

Acknowledgements

I would like to express sincere gratitude to Indroneel Chatterjee for his consistent supervision of this dissertation. His valuable time, guidance and knowledge helped shape this project, from the start and throughout.

I must also thank my partner, who has acted as a sounding board for the project, and has supported me at each stage from one to the next.

Finally, I'd like to express my appreciation for the friends I made on the MSc Marketing and Brand Management degree. Whilst separated by a global pandemic, we have stayed supportive of each other during our dissertation journeys, as well as in our personal and professional endeavours.

Abstract

This study examines consumer perceptions of product placement within the United Kingdom's entertainment industry. These perceptions are explored through a self-administered survey in which different forms of product placement were shown to participants. The results support the existing literature, whilst also uncovering several new conclusions that contribute to understanding of consumer perception towards product placement. A new model was created from the research that showcases five different factors that help create a perception of product placement, as well as the consumer's personal influences. The practical marketing industry implication of these findings are also discussed.

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1. Introduction

1.1. Background of the Study

What comes to mind when you think about advertising?

If you think of billboards, you'd be correct; if you think of posters on the side of buses, you'd be correct; if you think of three minute breaks between a television show, you'd be correct. However, these associations, whilst accurate, are becoming more and more outdated in the age of changing consumer habits.

The advertising industry has seen developments in recent years, enjoying a growth of 6.3% and a predicted increase of 32% by 2023 (Marketline, 2020c). Short form ads are said to be the most common type of advertisements nowadays, with long 30 second ads accounting for less than 50% of those currently being shown on television (WARC, 2018). Advertisements that utilise a brand character are, now, outperforming the competition by forming an emotional connection between character and consumer (WARC, 2019a), with characters set to become more central in a brand's communications strategy.

Out-of-home advertising, such as posters and billboards, have also seen changes in recent years, with a reported 40% decline since 2010, with this number rising to a 58% decline in larger sized billboards (Mediatel, 2019). These figures suggest that the growth in United Kingdom's advertising industry is a result of innovative new forms of advertising.

Of course brands are still utilising these traditional advertising tools – walk through the London Underground and you'll soon lose count of the posters you pass – but, recently, synergistic use of these methods with new advertising routes has become a common practice for brands to utilise in their strategy planning (WARC, 2020a).

One of these new practices is called product placement, which, for this dissertation, is defined as:

A form of advertising in which branded products are featured within entertainment content with an aim of raising awareness, generating sales or simply filling a prop space. Placements can be subtle, obvious, fee-based or non-fee-based. These placements may or may not involve a contractual agreement between brand and entertainment network (Author, 2020).

Product placement began being used in motion pictures as early as 1896, when a European film featured a laundry powder in the background (Chang et al, 2009). After making its way to the United States with Thomas Edison featuring Edison factory products in his entertainment (Chang et al, 2009), product placement began being used more regularly. When Reese's Pieces were used in *ET the Extra-Terrestrial* to lure the alien out of hiding, the chocolate's brand sales increased by 65% in a three month period after the film's release (Morton and Friedman, 2002). Other famed examples of product placement include Wilson Sporting Goods in *Cast Away*, the Apple episode of *Modern Family* and Cheetos in *Orange is the new Black*.



Figure 1: 'Cast Away' Wilson Sporting Goods (photo taken from Suffolk Gazette, 2020)



Figure 2: 'Modern Family' Apple Episode (photo taken from Quartz, 2015)

The placements act as a reinforcer (WARC, 2020a), highlighting the existing preconceptions that consumers have towards the branded product, whilst also presenting it in an everyday setting. Joey Tribbiani eating KFC in *Friends* tells the consumer that KFC serves fried chicken, is enjoyed by its customers and can be eaten in social settings; Carl using Ancestry.com in *Neighbours* displays to the consumer that the website can be used to track family history, is online and yields interesting results; Theresa using a Nokia phone in *Hollyoaks* shows that the product works well and is affordable. These characters using branded products has a powerful normalising effect on the consumer, and creates a sense that they are not being advertised to (WARC, 2020a).

Product placement has many advantages that traditional advertising lacks, such as its inability to be skipped or edited out (WARC, 2019b), as it is cleverly integrated into the content of the entertainment. Being integrated into content also means that the placement has a longer tail than traditional advertising, due to the

content's shelf-life on a streaming platform or on a DVD (Morton and Friedman, 2002).

According to PQ Media, the product placement market is growing by 15% every year, with the market value reaching \$7.15 billion in the US alone in 2018 (WARC, 2019b).

However, product placements aren't without their disadvantages as well. Subscription Video on Demand (SVOD) platforms are creating an immense amount of content in relation to changing consumer preferences for streaming services. This content is therefore creating a disadvantage for marketers, as it is getting harder to identify what will be popular (WARC, 2019b). Another disadvantage is that gauging consumer perceptions towards the placements can be near impossible. Due to the countless number of ways in which a branded product can be placed (obviously, subtly, comedically, seriously, physically, verbally, forefront, background), deciding what form will garner the best public response is difficult for marketers and production companies.

Various areas of product placement have been extensively studied, however there are some gaps in the research.

1.2. Purpose of the Study

The existing literature, which is reviewed in depth in Section 2, closely examines the effectiveness of product placement on areas such as brand recall, how placements can be categorised and how demographics react differently towards placements.

An area that hasn't been studied, however, is if consumer perception of the branded product is susceptible to influence from areas such as the entertainment itself and the manner in which the product is shown. For example, preconceptions of the entertainment could alter how a consumer perceives the product being placed; comedic placements may outperform those with a serious context and subtle placements may be perceived better or worse than obvious placements.

The purpose of this study is, therefore, to establish how consumers feel towards product placement, which 'type' of placement garners more positive perceptions, and the extent of the relationship between placement and entertainment. The study took place in the United Kingdom, based on a focus on United States' consumers in the existing research.

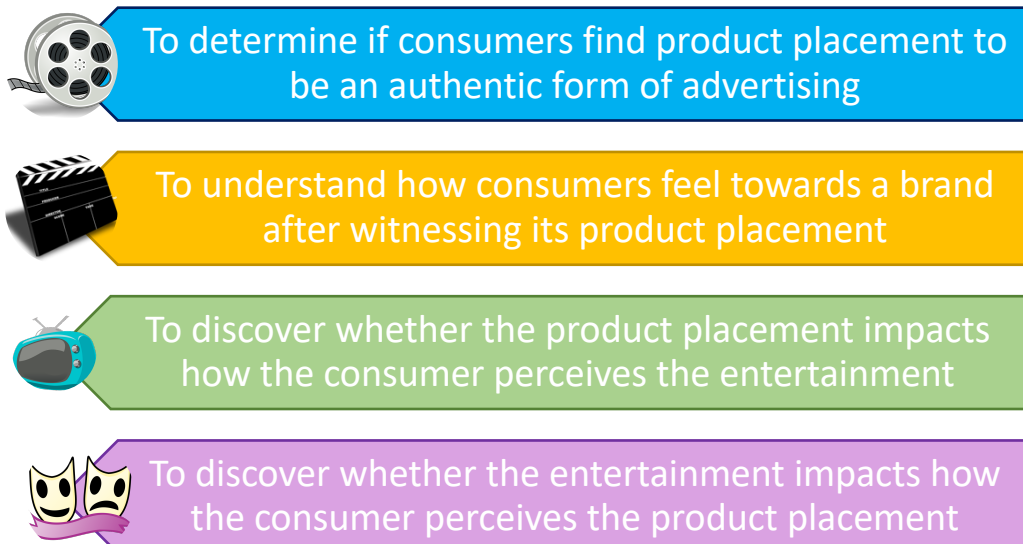


Figure 3: Research Objectives (Author, 2020)

1.3. Key Terms and Definitions

Product Placement: A form of advertising in which branded products are featured within entertainment content with an aim of raising awareness, generating sales or simply filling a prop space. Placements can be subtle, obvious, fee-based or non-fee-based. These placements may or may not involve a contractual agreement between brand and entertainment network (Author, 2020).

Consumer Perception: A process by which a consumer interacts with a stimuli and consciously or subconsciously decides how they will react to it. The stimuli can interact with any of the five senses, and must be above the consumer's Absolute Threshold (Author, 2020).

United Kingdom's Entertainment Industry: Any form of entertainment that is available for British consumers to view. This entertainment can be viewed on terrestrial television, a subscription-based streaming service or free streaming services. This means that "United Kingdom's Entertainment Industry" does not refer, only, to entertainment created, produced and distributed within the United Kingdom (Author, 2020).

1.4. Structure

This dissertation will follow a specific structure which details the research process that was undertaken:

Section 1 – Introduction: This Section has explained the background of the study, the state of the advertising industry and why product placement is becoming a more common practice for marketers. This Section also explored the purpose of the study, the research aims and objectives and the dissertation structure.

Section 2 – Literature Review: Section 2 will be the Literature Review. This is where the existing research is explored and reviewed in order to establish gaps in the research that need to be filled. The United Kingdom's entertainment industry, the concept of consumer perception and product placement research will be explored and reviewed.

Section 3 – Methodology: Section 3 is the Methodology chapter, in which the research process will be explained and justified. The data collection method will be outlined, as well as the sample method and the data analysis process.

Section 4 – Results and Analysis: Section 4 will present the results of the study and an analysis of the participants' responses will be made. This section will also establish the key themes of the study.

Section 5 – Discussion: Section 5 will be the discussion chapter, in which the findings of this study will be compared to those of the existing research. This section will also discuss whether or not the aims and objectives of the study have been met and if the research questions have been answered.

Section 6 – Conclusion: Section 6 will be the final section of the dissertation. This Section will draw the final conclusions based on the results of the study, as well as make recommendations for future research that needs to be done in the area of consumer perception of product placement.

2. Literature Review

2.1. Introduction

A literature review is conducted in order to garner a developed understanding of the existing research on a chosen topic. The review offers an overview of the important literature available and contributes to the development of an argument that contextualises and justifies primary research (Saunders et al, 2019).

By reviewing the existing literature on a topic, any gaps in the research are identified, which can then result in the primary research's aims, objectives and questions. The review provides the foundations of what a study will be built upon, helps hone the topic of research into a clear and realised focus-point and can also provide ways of collecting and analysing new data (Saunders et al, 2019).

The literature review for this study will be conducted in three sub-sections in order to fully understand the research topic. First, the United Kingdom's entertainment industry will be researched, then literature on consumer perception will be discussed, before outlining the existing research into product placement. A holistic understanding of the entertainment industry and of consumer perception helps determine significant definitions that play a large role in this study, and are based upon facts.

It is the literature exploring product placement that will be critically reviewed in order to determine gaps in the existing research. The product placement literature will be split into further sub-sections based upon the main focus of that research. These sub-sections are consumer attitudes, categorisation and current innovations.

2.2. UK Entertainment Industry

The existing literature on the entertainment industry in the United Kingdom will be reviewed by analysing market reports and market data that explores all areas of entertainment (films, broadcast TV, streaming and cinema). These reports will outline data concerning total revenues of different subareas of the entertainment industry, consumer attitudes/behaviours towards entertainment and predictions for the entertainment industry in the future based on existing figures.

2.2.1 Cinema

The cinema is a facet of the United Kingdom's entertainment industry, and has existed alongside modern viewing habits, dealing with various threats over the years, from VHS, to DVD, to piracy and, nowadays, streaming services (Mintel, 2019a).

The immense popularity of streaming services has been fuelled by developing technologies such as connected devices, cloud technologies and high-speed internet (Marketline, 2020a). Despite the various threats to its success, over 177 million ticket sales were made at the UK box office in 2018, and a decrease of just 0.6% in 2019 (Mintel, 2019a). The box office is valued as the revenues received from annual admissions (Marketline, 2020a). 43% of those who hadn't visited the cinema perceived the costs as too expensive, with a single cinema ticket averaging at £7 (Mintel, 2019a). Nearly a quarter of those who hadn't visited the cinema stated the reason being a preference for watching films in an alternative way, such as via streaming services or DVDs (Mintel, 2019a).

2.2.2 TV

This strong preference for alternative viewing habits has also impacted the TV facet of the entertainment industry; 6 in 10 people now watch TV through an on-demand service, with this figure reaching 9 in 10 people amongst the 16-24 demographic (Mintel, 2019b). TV shows are, now, often released via an on-demand service as well as on terrestrial television, such as *Killing Eve* – the show's finale garnered 1.9 million people watching on live TV, but a much larger number of 5.1 million people watching on BBC iPlayer (Mintel, 2019b).

Nearly three quarters of people watching content via an on-demand service have done so via paid streaming, however, there has been no observable change in the use of free streaming services, with 6 in 10 people watching content this way (Mintel, 2019b). With the younger, 16-24, demographic, almost half are watching live TV via a free streaming service, such as All4, BBC iPlayer or YouTube, whilst 4 in 10 are doing so through a paid streaming service, such as Now TV (Mintel, 2019b).

The United Kingdom accounts for 19.7% of the European broadcasting and cable TV market, with the market growing by 1.5% in the UK in 2019, to reach a total value of \$19.7 billion - this number is expected to grow by 5.6% in 2024 to reach \$20.8 billion (Marketline, 2020b).

TV subscriptions is the largest segment of the broadcast and cable TV market, making up 47.6% of the market's total value (Marketline, 2020b). TV advertising accounts for 28.2% and TV licences make up the remaining 24.1% (Marketline, 2020b).

Sky is a leading player in the broadcast and cable TV market, with over 24 million customers across several countries (Marketline, 2019b), and controls many of the popular TV stations/programmes. Other broadcast services pay Sky in order to televise these stations and programmes. However, BT has become an increasingly powerful player in the market, after securing a shared content agreement, allowing BT customers to access Sky, Netflix, Amazon Prime and other services via the BT platform (Marketline, 2020b). This has resulted in BT reaping in revenues of £4.66 billion in 2019 (Marketline, 2020b).

2.2.3 Media Industry

The United Kingdom's entire media industry (consisting of publishing, movies and entertainment, advertising and broadcast cable TV) grew by 3.7% in 2018, reaching a value of \$55.6 billion, with this figure forecast to increase by 16.4% by 2024, to reach \$64.7 billion (Marketline, 2019b). The United Kingdom accounts for 20.2% of Europe's media industry (Marketline, 2019b) and has been growing at an accelerated rate since 2016.

Advertising is the largest segment of the media industry, accounting for 50.3% of the media industry, broadcast/cable TV accounting for 26.6%, publishing accounting for 16.5% and movies and entertainment accounting for 6.5% (Marketline, 2019b).

2.2.4 Movies and Entertainment

The movies and entertainment market in the UK, consisting of producers and distributors of entertainment formats, has also suffered as a result of these changing consumer preferences for streaming. The market shrank by 4.4% in 2019, to reach a value of \$3, 286.9 million (Marketline, 2020a). This figure is expected to decrease by 19.7% in 2024, reaching \$2, 639.2 million, if current consumer trends continue.

However, the UK still accounts for 16.5% of the European movies and entertainment total market value (Marketline, 2020a).

Porter's Five Forces can be applied to the movies and entertainment market, to establish the buyers and suppliers, as well as the threat of substitutes. Large multiplex cinemas and smaller, more independent cinema companies act as the buyers in the movies and entertainment market (Marketline, 2020a). The larger UK cinema chains, such as Odeon and Cineworld, have strong financial power, which leads to a reliance on them from production companies to generate high box office numbers (Marketline, 2020a).

The suppliers for the movies and entertainment market are the skilled sets of crew working on a production, such as the actors, writers, director, set and costume design. Supplier power is concurrent with skill, as more experienced suppliers have higher power (Marketline, 2020a). Some of these suppliers may also rely on the film's success to make any money themselves, which decreases supplier power. However, switching costs during production are likely to be high, meaning the suppliers mostly have consistent work during filming (Marketline, 2020a). Supplier power is likely to increase overtime, as the growth of digital technologies means these creatives are able to distribute their own productions with ease over the internet (Marketline, 2020a).

This greater affordability of computer and digital equipment, as well as the ease of distribution via the internet is making entry to the movies and entertainment market increasingly possible, just on a much smaller scale (Marketline, 2020a). However, these entrants must compete with large Hollywood corporations with heavy financial muscle to spend on production and marketing.

Substitutes to the movies and entertainment market include streaming services and illegal online downloads through pirating (Marketline, 2020a).

Leading players in the movies and entertainment market consist of the Walt Disney Company, Comcast (NBC Universal Media), AT&T and the Sony Corporation (Marketline, 2020a). Similar to all forms of entertainment media, the main challengers to market leading players is streaming. Companies such as Netflix and Amazon Prime have gone on to produce their own original content, with Netflix having an original content budget of \$17 billion for 2020, and a loyal 12.4 million subscribers in the UK (Marketline, 2020a).

The original content created by these streaming services does receive accolades and attention from distinguished award organisations, in the way cinema-released films do. Netflix's *Atlantis* won an award at Cannes Film Festival in May 2019, and Amazon Prime's *Manchester by the Sea* won an Oscar in 2016 (Mintel, 2019a).

The consumer preference for streaming services is increasing the likelihood of cinemas forging strategic partnerships with streaming platforms, to turn unmissable content releases into events (Mintel, 2019a).

The fact that people's preferences have the power to alter whole industries proves that consumer perception is important for entertainment platforms to consider when developing future strategies.

2.2.5 Democratisation of the Entertainment Industry

Whilst the United Kingdom's entertainment industry can be clearly analysed as a differing entity completely separate from its overseas counterparts, from the eyes of the consumer, the entertainment industry is one body. This notion is becoming more accurate due to digital advancements, such as the proliferation of high-speed internet and the amount of consumer data apprehended by streaming services.

This evolution of internet capabilities has led to the formation of new dynamics between organisations and stakeholders (Asmussen et al, 2013). For example, British consumers are now able to view content that was once exclusive to a part of the world, such as programmes that were only shown on American terrestrial television. This can be done through streaming services that feature the content, or via illegal channels such as online piracy websites.

The development in internet capability of the average consumer has led to a power imbalance between organisations and their stakeholders (Asmussen et al, 2013). Due to the large volume of content easily available to British consumers nowadays, the United Kingdom's entertainment industry has suffered a loss of supplier power (Marketline, 2019b).

This democratisation of the entertainment industry means that, for this dissertation, the entertainment industry will follow the definition outlined in Section 1.4:

Any form of entertainment that is available for British consumers to view. This entertainment can be viewed on terrestrial television, a subscription-based streaming service or free streaming services. This means that “United Kingdom’s Entertainment Industry” does not refer, only, to entertainment created, produced and distributed within the United Kingdom (Author, 2020).

2.3. Consumer Perception

The definition of consumer perception is generally agreed upon in the literature, as well as the different elements involved. Kumra (2006) defined consumer perception as the process of selecting, organising and interpreting marketing stimuli based on an individual’s needs and values. This is similar to Nair’s (2008) definition who added that people select, organise and interpret data, and then add significance or meaning to it. Nair (2008) also described consumer perception as a cognitive thinking process.

The idea of selecting, organising and interpreting data is carried throughout the literature, with Soloman (2017) stating the process occurs in response to a person experiencing sensations. Sensations are described as the sensory receptors (touch, taste, smell, sight and sound) reacting to basic stimuli.

Jansson-Boyd (2010) also described consumer perception as a process of selecting, organising and interpreting stimuli, and involves attaching meaning to experienced sensations; perception is, therefore, completely subjective to each individual. Perception is said to be an active process, that continually categorises and interprets data gathered from our senses, and allows people to understand what the objects they interact with mean (Jansson-Boyd, 2010).

2.3.1 The Five Senses

This information from our senses helps contribute towards hedonic consumption, which refers to the multi-sensory fantasy and the emotional associations that consumers have with products (Soloman, 2017). These emotional associations consumers gather from their senses is important for marketers to understand, as they have been proven to influence purchasing behaviour: products are evaluated more harshly when consumers are stood on tile flooring, romance films are rated higher when watched in a cold room, and consumers are more likely to remember more product attributes if said product is scented (Soloman, 2017).

Of all the five senses, visual perception is the most prominent way for consumers to acquire information in a consumer environment, such as a store (Jansson-Boyd, 2010). Visual perception allows consumers to experience the existence of objects - their colour, shape and position - and is often the only way to gather an understanding of brands when there are many choices and options (Jansson-Boyd, 2010). A consumer's visual perception is important to a company, especially when operating in an over-saturated market with many different brands in the same category – visual aspects offer a way to differentiate a product, so that the brand and logo convey the intended meaning (Kumra, 2006). The visuals of a brand need to be appropriate so that the desired brand personality is created in the mind of the consumer (Kumra, 2006).

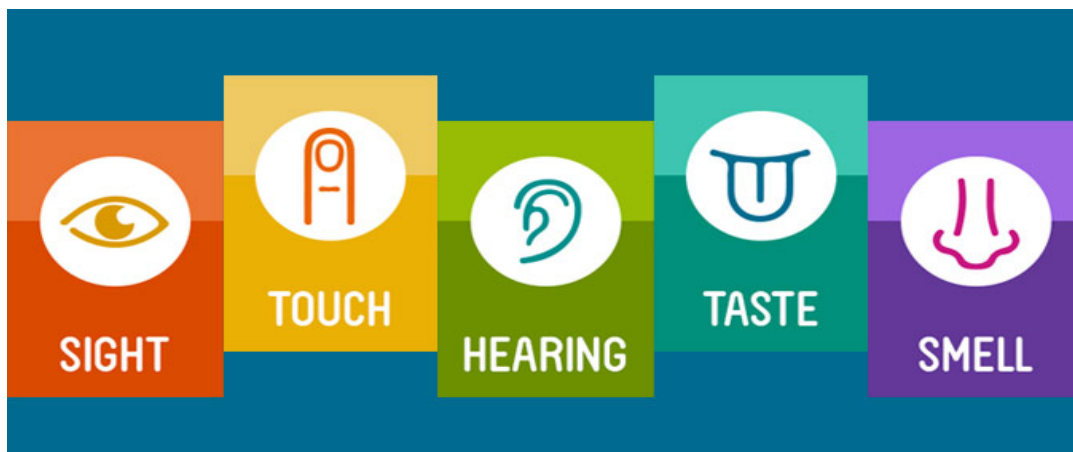


Figure 4: The Five Senses ([This Photo](#) by Unknown Author is licensed under [CC BY-NC-ND](#))

The first thing a consumer does in a consumer environment is a visual scan, with the aim of choosing a 'target' to focus on – perception starts functioning when this scan begins (Jansson-Boyd, 2010). The visual search is fuelled by underlying motivations held by the consumer, and these motivations will influence how visual stimuli is processed (Jansson-Boyd, 2010). For example, if consumers know buying one product leads to other bonuses, such as a discount, they will be more likely to have higher perceptions of this product. This is corroborated by Kumra (2006) who wrote that customers interpret stimuli based on their personal experiences, needs and expectations.

Whilst vision is the most prominent sense to create a consumer perception, the other senses can also have an impact. Different types of sounds are often used as a

communication tool for consumers (Jansson-Boyd, 2010), such as music playing in an advertisement on television to create a brand perception before ever encountering the product. It has been found that when stores play music that is heavily associated with a country, sales of products manufactured in that country increase (North, Hargreaves and McKendrick, 1999).

Odours also have the power to alter how consumers perceive products and environments. Able to be classified into two distinctions, odours are either non-ambient – from a particular product - or ambient – from a general presence, like a retail environment (Jansson-Boyd, 2010). The odours can garner specific memories or associations in the mind of the consumer, causing them to have positive or negative perceptions of certain products or retail environments (Jansson-Boyd, 2010).

Touch is another sense that creates a consumer perception; after visually scanning, the consumer will then touch the product to determine if it reaches expectations (Jansson-Boyd, 2010). This idea of expectations is also discussed by Nair (2008), who said that expectations affect how and what a person perceives; consumers often perceive what they expect, rather than the message they receive (Nair, 2008). It has been said that the consumer is 88% more likely to purchase a product if, after touching, it has met any expectations (Jansson-Boyd, 2010).

Taste is the final sense and is an important role in creating perceptions for specific consumer environments, such as a food/drink manufacturers.

2.3.2 Sensory Threshold

The research into consumer perceptions also discusses the sensory threshold. This concept refers to the amount to which an individual is capable of perceiving (Soloman, 2017). An Absolute Threshold is the term meaning the minimum amount of stimulation an individual can identify on one given sensory (Soloman 2017; Kumra, 2006, Nair, 2008, Schiffman et al, 2013). In more basic terms, it is the minimum number of stimuli required to get noticed by a person; for example, if someone is driving on the motorway and is just about able to read the text on an advertising billboard, this is that person's Absolute Threshold for vision.

Differential Threshold is described by Kumra (2006) as the minimum difference an individual can notice between two stimuli. However, Soloman (2017) describes

Differential Threshold as the ability of someone's sensory system to detect changes (Soloman, 2017) between two stimuli. If a consumer is deciding between two products in the same category – for example, laptops – the person's ability to notice the difference between the two products – colour, shape, size of hard drive – is their Differential Threshold. According to Soloman (2017), the minimum difference a consumer can detect is the Just Noticeable Difference.

Soloman (2017) also discusses the ideas of Ernst Weber, a 19th century psychophysicist. Weber found that the amount of change required for the perceiver to notice the said change is related to the intensity of the original stimulus. The stronger level of the intensity, the greater the change must be to be detected by the perceiver (Soloman, 2017). This idea is referred to as Weber's Law.

The aim of most marketers will be to create stimuli above the consumers' thresholds, as to get noticed. If the message falls below consumer awareness, then it becomes subliminal and faces criticism over the ethics. However, what most consumers perceive as subliminal advertisements are, in fact, not at all and are designed to be noticed (Soloman, 2017). If a consumer can see or hear the message then, of course, it is in no way subliminal, it is just reaching the Absolute Threshold of that consumer.

2.3.3 Selection, Organisation and Interpretation

The literature investigating consumer perception generally agrees on the process that takes place, following a three-step process of selection, organisation and interpretation.



Figure 5: Perception Process (Author, 2020)

Perceptual selection involves the consumer selecting an amount of the marketing stimuli to which they are exposed to focus on (Kumra, 2006). Nair (2008) discusses the idea of perceptual defence, which refers to an individual being vigilant towards

stimuli and choosing to ignore the stimuli that they may find threatening or conflicting. Solomon (2017) labels the first step of the process as exposure, and defines this as the occurrence of a stimulus coming into range of a person's sensory receptors. This links with Nair's (2008) ideas of perceptual vigilance, as Solomon (2017) explains how consumers focus on some stimuli or purposefully go out of their way to ignore others.

The organisation process has been the subject of intensive research, that has become known as the Gestalt school of psychology (Jansson-Boyd, 2010). Gestalt psychologist suggested a series of laws regarding how stimuli are organised by individuals: the law of proximity, the law of closure, the law of similarity and the figure-ground principle (Jansson-Boyd, 2010). The law of proximity refers to stimuli that are close and, therefore, get grouped together; the law of closure is when individuals fail to observe the irregularities in geometrical figures and fill in the gaps based on their prior experiences of those figures; the law of similarity is when consumers perceive two stimuli as being essentially the same based on their salient features; and the figure-ground principle is where one stimulus stands out as well-defined (figure) and the other is seen as less prominent (ground) (Jansson-Boyd, 2010). With the latter principle, the more familiar the stimulus, the easier it becomes for the individual to determine what is the figure and what is the ground.

The interpretation of the stimulus is said to be unique to the individual, fulfilling their own interests, wishes and needs (Kumra, 2006). It is also dependent on what this individual is expecting to see based upon previous experiences, as well as their interests and motives at the time of perception (Nair, 2008).

2.3.4 Positioning

Consumer perception is important when it comes to the positioning of brands and products. Companies use consumer perception to effectively convey a meaning through brand image and create a position in the mind of the consumer (Kumra, 2006). A brand's positioning strategy is generally two-pronged (Kumra, 2006), coinciding with the consumer's needs and differentiating from the competition.

A distinctive brand image in the mind of the consumer is the result of a successful positioning strategy, as well as brand loyalty and positive perceptions associated with that brand.

However, customers are bombarded with advertisements every day (Kumra, 2006) and it is getting increasingly more difficult for brands to reach consumers' Absolute Threshold; the immense number of advertising stimuli that people are subjected to is leading to higher levels of perceptual vigilance and defence (Nair, 2008).

This strong need to be positioned in the consumers' mind – and the need to create perceptions – has led to new and innovative channels of advertising in recent years. One of these channels is disguising sales and messages, by partnering with films and television shows to include their brand/product within the entertainment. This new way of advertising is called Product Placement.

2.4. Product Placement

The existing literature exploring product placement reveals detailed insight into several focused areas of this form of advertisement: consumer attitudes, categorisation and current innovations of product placement are the main areas that have been investigated. By exploring the existing research, a comprehensive understanding of product placement's effectiveness in terms of purchasing behaviour and recollection of the placed brands, as well as audience perception, is able to be achieved.

A significant aim of product placement is to make sure the consumer can 1) identify the brand being placed and 2) remember the brand once it has visibly or verbally left the action of the entertainment. Ong and Meri (1994), in their study into product placement planning, found that the viewers were not able to recall the brands that had been advertised in the shown entertainment. This finding contradicts with Babin and Carder (1996) whose study into viewers recognition of placed brands within films found that many products/brands could be identified. One possible explanation for this difference in findings is that viewer recognition of brands and consumer memory of a placement is enhanced when the principal character/leading actor/actress are present (d'Astous and Chartier, 2000). If the product placement examples used by Ong and Meri (1994) featured with a background character/supporting actor, then according to results by d'Astous and Chartier (2000), viewers are less likely to recall the brand.

A paper by Homer (2009) explores the effect of repetition of product placements, and compares those that are subtle with those that are obvious. This study found that the type of placement and its repetition work together to impact placement related judgements (Homer, 2009). The repetition of the obvious placements had a negative impact on brand attitude, whilst for subtle placements, the attitudes were relatively positive and repetition had little impact (Homer, 2009).

Johnstone and Dodd (2000) found that viewers who enjoyed the entertainment in which a product was being placed, had higher levels of self-monitoring and brand salience. Recognition and recollection of the placed product was also found to be higher in verbal and plot-related placements (Johnstone and Dodd, 2000).

In terms of the planning, motion pictures have been found to be an appropriate vehicle for the form of advertising to be utilised, with Morton and Friedman (2002) highlighting the long shelf-life that entertainment has in comparison to traditional advertising.

The idea of a long-shelf life is corroborated by d'Astous and Chartier (2000), who discussed reasons why marketers consider product placement to be an effective communications strategy. Another reason why was due to the high level of involvement that characterises watching a film in a cinema – the dim lighting and minimal noise levels increase a consumer's focal attention onto the screen (d'Astous and Chartier, 2000). Another reason is due to the non-aggressive or disruptive way of advertising a product (d'Astous and Chartier, 2000).

The product placement within these motion pictures was also found to be efficiently planned, as to increase positive association between moviegoer and consumer (Redondo, 2006). The effectiveness and success of the product placement planning, however, relies on the relationship between placement and entertainment (Redondo, 2006), similar to findings by Johnstone and Dodd (2000); the targeting accuracy of the placements is significantly higher when the placements are highly connected to the plot – a possible reason for this is due to the more lengthy planning (Redondo, 2006); if the brand/product is connected to the plot, then the product itself and the audience that will be watching is more thoroughly assessed.

2.4.1 Consumer Attitudes

The attitudes of the consumers in relation to product placement has been researched considerably, with most of these studies reaching useful and, in some cases, similar conclusions. A parasocial attachment between consumers and television characters has been observed (Russel et al, 2006), with a character's thoughts and actions influencing a consumer's product placement attitude; however, Gregorio and Sung (2010) concluded that demographic characteristics do have an impact. Gregorio and Sung (2010) found that demographic characteristics do affect a consumer's attitudes towards product placement, with females holding a more positive opinion than that of males. The consumer's education level also influences product placement perceptions, with higher-educated participants having more negative associations (Gregorio and Sung, 2010). Those over the age of 55 also indicated less favourable product placement attitudes (Gregorio and Sung, 2010).

Auty and Lewis (2004) explored the effectiveness of product placement on children, in regard to memory and product choice after witnessing the placement. In this study, the design factors were prior exposure to the placement and the presence or absence of a reminder of what the placement was. The children that had been exposed to the placement and those who were given a placement reminder were more likely to choose the placed branded product compared to those who did not get the reminder (Auty and Lewis, 2004). This highlights that product placement, for children, can be deemed as somewhat forgettable and can only be said to be effective if children are reminded of the placement.

Attitudes towards advertising in general are also thought to influence attitude towards brand advertising in entertainment, with those who watch film and television more frequently believed to be more accepting of product placement (Gupta and Gould, 1997).

An older study by Goldberg and Gorn (1987) investigated the impact of emotion on product placement's audience response. The design factors in this study were the emotional style of the television programme, as they were categorised as either happy or sad. This study also utilised adverts, which were categorised as either emotional or informational (Goldberg and Gorn, 1987). This resulted in the happier programme inducing a happier mood, leading to a greater perceived effectiveness of the advert on the participants (Goldberg and Gorn, 1987). There

was also a significant interaction between the television programme and the advert, such that the effect of the programme on viewers' mood was greater for the group watching the emotional adverts compared to those watching the informational adverts (Goldberg and Gorn, 1987).

This idea of significant interaction can be linked with Russel et al's (2006) idea of a parasocial attachment between consumers and television characters and when the actors physically handle the product. If a strong connection is perceived between character and product, and the character's thoughts/actions to the product are negative, then the consumer's attitude towards the product will be negative (Russel et al, 2006). Similarly, if a character's thoughts/actions towards the product is positive, then the consumer's attitudes will also be positive, regardless of the character's relationship to the product (Russel et al, 2006). This data highlights the importance of a character's effect on viewers' attitudes as they will align their opinion(s) with those of the inside-program characters.

Thinkbox's (2015a) research corresponds with that of Russel et al (2006) which found that brands shape viewer's perceptions of people on TV and that people on TV shapes perceptions of the brands they're using. This research also revealed that brand and programme fit is key to be deemed acceptable by the viewer – the placement needs to be natural and not forced, otherwise it will be rejected (Thinkbox, 2015a).

Thinkbox (2015a) discusses research done by ITV who looked at the emotional response of brand attributes. ITV found that relevant product placement does not interrupt the viewing experience of the entertainment as it fits the storyline and is seen as a natural addition. 91% of viewers in this study believed that seeing the placements did not impact their enjoyment, with a small 7% adding that the product placement actually enhanced their experience (Thinkbox, 2015a).

Some consumers question the ethics of product placement, with Gupta and Gould (1997) splitting these concerns into two categories: general concerns about product placement and concerns about a specific product.

A significant ethical concern that consumers may have towards product placement is the worry of deception (Gupta and Gould, 1997), as product placement provides the consumer with a sense that they are not being advertised to (WARC, 2020a). This can be linked with the idea of subliminal perception, which refers to any stimulus that falls below an individual's Absolute Threshold (Solomon, 2017).

Subliminal advertisements/messages are taboo due to their lack of clarity, which leads to the, somewhat accurate, assumption that brands are deceiving consumers in order to make sales. However, Soloman (2017) explains that subliminal advertising is a much rarer phenomenon compared to common belief – if you notice the advert then there is nothing subliminal about it.

Another general ethical concern is the economic impact that product placement may be having on the advertising market (Gupta and Gould, 1997). Consumers may begin to ignore certain brands, in favour of the products that have been advertised to them via a big budget, star-studded, Hollywood production. However, product placement is innovating simultaneously with the entertainment industry and more affordable placement opportunities are sprouting (WARC, 2020a). This means that smaller and more independent brands can advertise via entertainment content too.

There is also consumer concern about product placement, in respect to its use of specific products (Gupta and Gould, 1997). Unethical products include cigarettes, alcohol and guns, as found by Gupta and Gould, (1997).

2.4.2 Categorisation of Placements

The existing literature has explored the categorisation of product placement, from how 'obvious' the placement is within the entertainment to the different ways in which the placement is organised through the entertainment company. Gupta and Lord (1998) argues that product placements can be organised based on their mode of presentation, which consist of visual only (where the product is displayed on screen), audio only (where the product and brand-related messages are referred to) and combined audio-visual (showing the product and referring to it) (Gupta and Lord, 1998).

The literature exploring these modes of presentation found that visual only placements are the most utilised, however, this presentation mode may result in low levels of recollection (Gupta and Lord, 1998). An explanation for these low recollection levels is the lack of audio reinforcement of the brand, which is overcome with combined audio-visual product placement, though this mode is more expensive (Gupta and Lord, 1998).

Thinkbox (2015b) discussed types of product placement also, with their categories similar to Gupta and Lord's (1998), however, these are expanded into six different subsets: product used onscreen, product seen but not used, verbally mentioned, musically, contextually and unbranded. Brands are often used onscreen (Thinkbox, 2015b), such as Samsung phones being used on Netflix's *Next in Fashion*, where the contestants were filmed taking photos with the phone and discussing its innovative charging features. A brand may also be part of the set as a prop but not physically interacted with (Thinkbox, 2015b), such as a type of coffee in the background of a film or may be referred to by somebody onscreen verbally. Music can also be a form of product placement (Thinkbox, 2015b), for example, a new album by Ministry of Sound synergising with the television show *Love Island* to be played in the background and in its advertisements. Product placements can also be contextual, such as a digital poster within a natural setting of a television programme and can be completely unbranded.

Another form of categorisation is the placement's level of prominence within the entertainment – a placement's level of prominence is determined by its physical size and position on the screen, as well as how vital the product/brand is to the action (Gupta and Lord, 1998). As well as prominent placements, a product can be displayed in a subtle manner, in which the brand is not shown prominently (smaller size, prop in the background or less time exposure) (Gupta and Lord, 1998).

This idea of a product placement being 'prominent' is closely linked to Redondo's (2005) and Johnstone and Dodd's (2000) findings that plot-related placements had higher levels of recollection. Studies by Brennan et al (1999) revealed that brand/product recognition is common with prominent placements, similar to other older research, before digital growth, which highlighted that prominence and centrality to 'action' is positively correlated with attention/recollection; Finn (1988) found that increasing the size of a printed advertisement increases the prospect of attracting attention from the reader. Another older study from Engel et al (1993), that researched retail shelf location, concluded that occupying a more prominent position within the visual space will lead to increased consumer attention.

These findings of prominent/plot-related product placements being more effective – concluded by Redondo (2006), Johnstone and Dodd (2000), Brennan et al (1999), Finn (1988) and Engel et al (1993) - were corroborated by Gupta and Lord

(1998); this research utilised the two-dimensional categorisation approaches (mode of presentation and its prominence) to study the recollection levels of placed brands on moviegoers. Recall levels of the prominent placement were significantly higher than that of the subtle placement, with 90% recall compared to 35% (Gupta and Lord, 1998). A traditional advert showcased within a film also had greater recall results than the subtle product placement, with 63% over 5.6% (Gupta and Lord, 1998). Though the advertising stimulus had high recall results, the prominent placement was still greater (90% - 60%) (Gupta and Lord, 1998).

Contradicting the findings by Russel et al (2006), Gupta and Lord (1998) found that the superior recall levels for prominent product placements were based purely on the prominence of the placement, and not characteristics or attitudes of the leading actor/actress.

Whilst the mode of presentation and the level of prominence can be used to categorise product placements, different methods of categorisation can be identified when investigating the planning process. Redondo (2006) studied the planning of product placement in relation to the moviegoers/consumers, whilst Chang et al (2009) uses in-depth interviews with studios and marketing firms to showcase how brands and products become embedded within film and television.

Through studying the process, three different forms of product placement were identified: serendipitous placement, opportunistic placement and planned placement. Serendipitous product placements are those that occur through chance, and are extremely short term (Chang et al, 2009). For example, if a film set requires a space to be filled by a shelf item, a jar of Nutella may be chosen at random to be placed. This is an informal product placement, lacking a contractual agreement, lasting only a short duration of time and tactically used to fill an empty space (Chang et al, 2009).

Opportunistic placements are more predictable than serendipitous placements and occur when a film script is scanned for product placement opportunities and sent to representatives of corporate brands; if they approve of the opportunity then the brand and entertainment firm will negotiate a partnership (Chang et al, 2009).

Planned product placements are when an entertainment firm has previously agreed to exclusively use a brand within their media. These types of placements are characterised by their predictability and the formal contractual relationship between brand and entertainment company (Chang et al, 2009).

By collaborating with an entertainment firm, a perceptible outward expression associated with a brand is created in the eye of the consumers (Asmussen et al, 2016). Having their product placed can be defined as a form of branded content/entertainment. In its most basic form, this is defined as content created for or by a particular brand (Asmussen et al, 2016), for example, 'Extra' chewing gum sponsoring a dating show on Channel 4, or the Suzuki car manufacturer producing short films with television duo Ant and Dec on ITV.

Zuckerman et al (2015) furthers understanding of branded content/entertainment by explaining the consumer benefit and the authenticity attached to the content, which traditional advertising is believed to lack.

The branded content/entertainment has further methods of categorisation, similar to the many labels associated with product placement, put forward by Redondo (2006), Gupta and Lord (1998) and Chang et al (2009). Zuckerman et al (2015) found that there were three kinds of content: product-related, category-related and general-interest content.

These different types of content are then delivered on three different types of platforms: existing media (such as a television show), a brand's own media (their website or social medias) or a new platform that was created specifically for the branded content (Zuckerman et al, 2015).

2.4.3 Current Innovations

Existing research into product placement also discusses how the advertising tool is innovating congruently with changing consumer viewing habits. 6 in 10 people now watch TV through an on-demand service, with this figure rising to 9 in 10 people amongst the 16-24 demographic (Intel, 2019b). As entertainment consumption habits become more digital, product placement insertions must follow in its footsteps in order to continue its effectiveness.

Branded Entertainment Networks found that 74% of Netflix's original content contained product placements in 2018, with this figure rising to 91% in Hulu's original content (WARC, 2020a).

One way in which product placement is being future-proofed is the use of dynamic digital insertion technology, which enables the placements to be fully targeted and personalised (WARC, 2020a). Artificially intelligent (AI) driven

advertising tools are being applied to the data that streaming services store in relation to their consumers (demographics, preferences, habits) (WARC, 2020b). These AI-driven programmatic tools automatically overlay interchangeable products within the entertainment content, meaning that the product being placed can be altered depending on the consumer who's watching (WARC, 2020b). If a consumer has been researching online for a specific product, for example a new mobile, the cookies/cached data from online can be utilised by streaming services to display the mobile product into the consumer's content. This differentiation of products offers a fully personalised and relevant placement experience for each consumer.

This also helps guarantee that the advertising content is always fresh, as branded products can jump in and out whenever the placement is relevant to their target consumers (WARC, 2020b), rather than being tied to one particular agreement.

Product placement has been, in the past, utilised by big-name FMCG brands (Baines and Fill, 2014) who have the financial weight to throw around (WARC, 2020a).

The growth in popularity and preference of streaming services is leading the growth in more affordable product placement programming options. This means that the advertising tool is no longer only accessible by well-known brands, but smaller more independent brands also have the opportunity to integrate products into content (WARC, 2020b).

Due to these more affordable programming options, product placement is now being yielded as an equaliser between large and small brands (WARC, 2019b), as they both have access to cost-effective exposure. There still is that multi-million dollar component to product placement, that exists with larger brands utilising the placement opportunities created by film studios/networks (Smith and Zook, 2016), however, the streaming service side of product placement has been and still is growing.

Another innovation in the product placement market is the various monitoring services, such as Critical Mention or Concave Brand Tracking (WARC, 2019b) that follow mentions of the product across all platforms. These help the marketers analyse how impactful a product placement has been on raising brand awareness, and gauges the impression that consumers had towards the product.



Figure 6: 'Stranger Things' and Burger King (Ad Week, 2019)

The concept of green product placement (Paluck et al, 2015) can also be yielded as a current innovation. Production companies are now including more environmentally-friendly product placements into their content, as a way of defining characters and driving storylines (WARC, 2019b). These types of products are becoming more mainstream in consumers' everyday life so, therefore, are being reflected on their screens.

Another form of innovation that the industry is seeing more of, as the value of product placement in streaming is being realised, is co-promotional approaches to their communication strategies, including online tools as well as more traditional offline tools (WARC, 2020b). For example, Netflix formed a collaboration with the fast food chain, Burger King, to promote *Stranger Things*. This was done through the "Upside Down Whopper" burger which synergised with the fictional alternative world to which the show's characters referred to as the "Upside Down.

2.5 The Research Gaps

After analysing the existing literature that explores product placement, several gaps in the research have been identified, which have become the fundamental objectives of this study into consumer perceptions of product placement. These gaps have also led to the creation of research questions for this study.

As observed throughout Section 2.4 of the literature review, a lot of the existing research into product placement – particularly consumer attitudes (Section 2.4.1) - is several years old, with some reviewed texts dating back to the 90s. This is significantly problematic, as it means the results cannot be labelled as reliable, however insightful they have been. If those studies were repeated now with the same sample, it is highly unlikely that the same results would be yielded, due to a drastic change in consumer habits, as well as a dynamic shift of what entertainment looks like and how its consumed by individuals (discussed in Section 2.2).

Luckily, research into current innovations of product placement, which was presented in Section 2.4.3 is refreshingly recent. This makes this literature extremely useful, as the data is modern and concerns itself with modern-day viewers and modern-day product placement.

The 'expired' research, however, presents this study with a research gap: new literature into consumers' attitudes towards product placement. This 2020 study will allow marketers to understand how modern viewers perceive product placement.

Another gap which this research will fill is exploring product placement perceptions in a time of online streaming of entertainment. As the reviewed literature is years old, none of it considers the impact of streaming services and how these new entertainment platforms are providing placement opportunities. Hence, this research will provide an insight into how streaming-focused-consumers perceive product placement.

The existing research does not fully investigate the relationship between the placed product and the entertainment, so it is undetermined whether or not one affects the other in regard to consumer perception. This has led to the creation of two of the research questions which will be outlined in Section 3.2.2. It has also not been explored if the seriousness of the placement impacts perceptions, which is why this study will include Comedic product placements in its research.

Whilst the idea of prominent placements has been explored by a lot of the research, this research has been intently concerned with prominence and brand recognition/recall – there is a surprising lack of research into prominence of placements and consumer opinion of the prominence. This has led to a vital objective and research question for this study: what type of product placement do consumers prefer?

A final gap in the existing research is the lack of any model that links directly to consumer perceptions and product placement. The creation of a model would help marketers understand the different factors that contribute to a perception of product placement.

These gaps in the research have led to the creation of research objectives and questions which will be outlined in Section 3.2.2 of the Methodology. These objectives and questions will help build the method of data collection of the study, which will yield the results to fill the gaps of existing knowledge into consumer perceptions of product placement.

3. Methodology

3.1. Introduction

Research, for marketing, is the process of designing, collecting and reporting information and data that can be used to solve a specific problem (Burns et al, 2017). In relation to this study – consumer perceptions of product placement in UK entertainment – the research will be used to comprehend how consumers react to and feel towards brands and entertainment that utilise product placement as a form of advertisement.

The research will also function as a link between consumer and marketers, by providing useful information that can be utilised in marketing decision making (Burns et al, 2017), specifically with advertising products through an entertainment platform.

The methodology chapter of this dissertation will outline how the research into consumer perceptions of product placement will be conducted. The research strategy, approach and data collection method will be explained and justified in order for the study to effectively proceed. Ethical considerations will also be discussed, so that the participants are aware of their rights and fully understand the process and what will happen with their data and responses.

3.2. Research Strategy

In regard to product placement in entertainment, academic research already exists and has been reviewed in the literature review. Hence, this research will take the form of new research on an existing subject matter (Bryman et al, 2019), with a prominent focus on consumer perceptions. This research will also be focusing on British consumers.

3.2.1 Research Philosophy

The philosophy of research refers to the beliefs and assumptions (Saunders et al, 2019) that relate to the process of the data collection. For this study, an interpretivist approach will be used, meaning that the focus will be on understanding thoughts and opinions (Bradley, 2013). The fundamentals of this investigation are to learn about

consumer perceptions, hence a positivist philosophy that aims to understand facts (Saunders et al, 2019) is not useful or relevant.

3.2.2 Research Approach

An inductive approach will be utilised for this research, as questions, aims and objectives are established before and then achieved during the process (Walliman, 2011). The aim of this research is to explore how consumers perceive the use of product placement by brands within the UK entertainment industry.



Figure 3: Research Objectives (repeated)
(Author, 2020)

As explained further by Saunders et al (2019), inductive research aims to understand its subjects and how they interpret the world. Therefore, the inductive approach is commonly used with qualitative data (Bryman and Bell, 2015). This approach allows an in-depth understanding into the meanings behind what the participants say in regard to product placement – whereas, the deductive approach is far more rigid and doesn't allow for multiple explanations of

a subject (Saunders et al, 2019).

The study's research design can

be described as descriptive research, as it aims to uncover how consumers perceive product placement. Descriptive research sets out to answer who, what, where, when and how questions (Bradley, 2013; Chisnall, 2004). This research can be categorised as either cross-sectional or longitudinal; cross-sectional studies focus on a sample group at only one point in time, compared to longitudinal studies that measure that sample over a period of time (Sontakki, 2010).

This research will take a cross-sectional approach, which has the main advantage of being efficient and can quickly prove or disprove assumptions. However, a cross-sectional study means

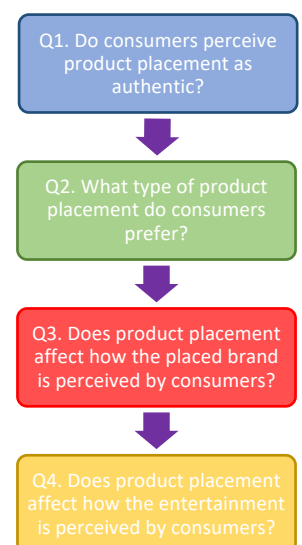


Figure 7: Research Questions (Author, 2020)

establishing cause and effect is harder, and the short length of research means the results may not be representative (Malhotra, 2017).

3.2.3 Research Method

In order to answer the research questions, shown in Figure 7, and to satisfy the aims and objectives, Figure 3, of the study, both qualitative and quantitative data will be collected and analysed, making this a mixed methods research (Merriam and Tisdell, 2016).

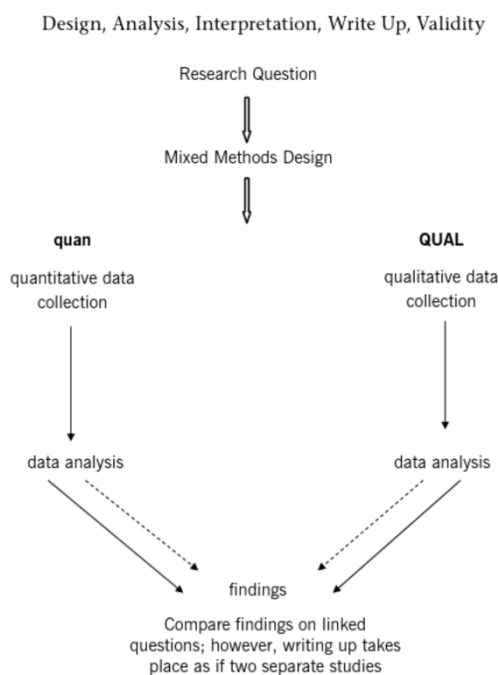


Figure 8: Mixed-Methods Research (Hesse-Biber, 2010)

also aims to distinguish if consumers actually prefer product placement over traditional advertising and quantifying these preferences will allow for easy comparison.

The disadvantages of each method are cancelled out by using mixed methods; the difficulty in generalising qualitative data to the wider population and the lack of a comprehensive understanding that quantitative data are not impacting the results (Watkins and Gioia, 2015).

Both techniques will be used as the quantitative data allows for efficiency and ease in analysing which example of product placement the participants preferred, whilst the quantitative data means their reasoning for their preferences can be fully expanded. Qualitative research allows for detailed description of the participant's thoughts and opinions (Atieno, 2009; Burns et al, 2017). This study is interested in garnering a detailed collection of consumer perceptions of product placement, hence why qualitative data is appropriate. However, the numerical nature of quantitative data is appropriate too as the study

Key point

Qualitative data analysis is concerned with the following:

- *Data management and organization*: an initial process of carving up the mass of unwieldy data into manageable chunks by coding, memoing and summarizing them into patterns and configuration.
- *Asking questions of the data*: what is going on? Who says? Where and when is it happening?
- *Interpretation*: bringing meaning and insight to the words and acts of participants in the study by generating concepts and theories (or theory-based generalizations) which explain the findings. The key question to ask and answer at this point is: 'So what does this finding mean in the light of the literature and my main research question?' You then communicate the meaning of your findings to others through your written report.

Figure 9: Qualitative Data (Daymon and Holloway, 2010)

3.3. Data Collection Method

The research questions will be explored via a self-administered survey (SAS), created using Google Forms, in which the participant conducts content analysis. In a self-administered survey, the participants complete a survey on their own without an interviewer asking the questions and recording the answers (Burns et al, 2017).

For this survey, the participant will be shown three clips from film and television that have product placement in; these clips will either be Obvious or Subtle. A third category, Comedic, will also be explored, to fill the gap in the research that doesn't explore if the seriousness of the product placement has an impact on consumer perception.

Obviousness, as explained by Gupta and Lord (1998), relates to the physical size and position on the screen, as well as the importance to the action. For this dissertation, Obvious placements are when the branded product is physically handled or verbally referred to by the entertainment's characters, and Subtle placements are when the branded product is not handled by or talked about by the characters. Comedic placements are categorised by the use of humour by the entertainment's characters towards the branded product.

The literature review uncovered that consumers have different responses based on the placement's prominence, hence why Obvious/Subtle are used as categories. The existing research, however, didn't investigate fully the effect of the style of product placement on consumers, leading to the Comedic category.

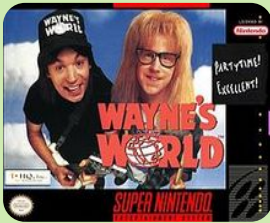
After watching each example, the participants will be asked to rate how they feel towards the product being placed, and how they feel towards the entertainment. This will be done on a scale of 1 (negatively) to 5 (positively). The participant will then be asked to explain their answer if they can, using words. All clips will be exported from YouTube and embedded into the Google Forms survey.

**EXAMPLE ONE:**

- Taken from *Hawaii Five-0*
- Obvious Product Placement
- Available on British terrestrial television
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oQYwFND7rHE> (YouTube, 2012)

**EXAMPLE TWO:**

- Taken from *Stranger Things*
- Subtle Product Placement
- Available on Netflix
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wxMEWhcyrVU> (YouTube, 2017)

**EXAMPLE THREE:**

- Taken from *Wayne's World*
- Comedic Product Placement
- Available on DVD
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8lgLYGBbDNs> (YouTube, 2013)

Figure 10: Product Placement Study Examples (Author, 2020)

The first example that the participants watch will be Obvious, as the branded product is used prominently by a character. This example features *Hawaii Five-0* placing the Subway brand; the placement does not fit in with the show's style.

Example Two is Subtle, as the product is not handled by or spoken about by the entertainment's characters. This example is taken from *Stranger Things* placing Coca-Cola, with the placement well-integrated into the entertainment.

Example Three will be Comedic to observe if the humour has an effect on consumer perception towards the placement. This example is taken from *Wayne's World*, and features many branded products including Pepsi, Doritos, Reebok and Pizza Hut. Whilst Example Three has been chosen based on the humour, the placements can be described as Obvious too.

There will also be a fourth clip, which will be a compilation of traditional adverts that a consumer would see on television. After watching this, the participant will be asked to rate how they feel towards the advertised products on the same scale of 1 to 5. Like the product placement clips, they will also be asked to explain their numerical response using words.

The reason for showing Example Four is to compare participant opinions between product placement and traditional advertising.

After watching all clips and answering the questions, the participants will be asked what example they preferred out of the three product placement clips to garner an understanding of what type of placement is 'the best'.

Finally, the participants will be asked if they prefer product placement or traditional advertising, and then asked to explain their choice using words.

When evaluating a data collection method, there are seven factors that need to be considered.

Figure 11: Evaluating Data Collection (adapted from Krishnaswami and Satyaprasad, 2010)(Author, 2020)



One advantage of using SAS is that they are cheap to make and to send out to participants (Burns et al, 2017), making them efficient cost-wise (Clippinger, 2017). Depending on the length of the study, SAS is also a quick form of data collection (Smith et al, 2018).

As the participant administers the questions to themselves, the need for an interviewer or device to interview the participant is eliminated (Burns et al, 2017). The participant also controls the pace at which they answer the questions (Malhotra, 2017), which creates a more relaxed environment as they wouldn't feel rushed or pressured by the researcher. This relaxed experience may lead to more accurate answers and will encourage the participant to continue the process (Ghauri and Gronhaug, 2010). As well as this, there is reduced anxiety associated with completing the survey, as the participant is alone and won't feel external influence from the researcher (Walliman, 2011).

This survey will be created and completed using Google Forms. The advantage of computer-administered surveys is the user-friendly features, as they are simple to complete if the user has basic computer skills (Burns et al, 2017; Clippinger, 2017). The obvious disadvantage is that they require internet-connected respondents who are computer literate (Malhotra, 2017).

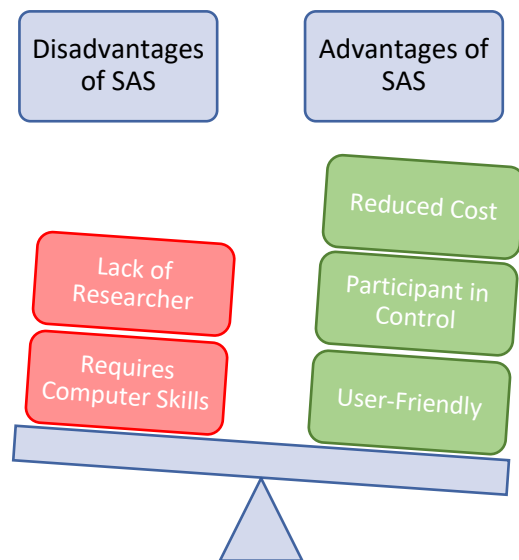


Figure 12: Advantages and Disadvantages of Self-Administered Surveys (Author, 2020)

	No Computer	Computer
Interviewer	Person administered Interviewer reads questions and records the answers on paper.	Computer assisted Interviewer reads the questions and uses computer technology to record the answers and/or otherwise assist in the interview.
No interviewer	Self-administered Respondent reads the questions on a page and responds by writing on the questionnaire.	Computer administered Computer communicates the questions and records the respondent's answers.

Figure 13: Computer Assisted Surveys (Burns and Bush, 2016)

3.4 Selection of Sample

A river sampling technique will be used for this study, which is an online method of inviting a website's visitors to take part (Burns et al, 2017). The link to the Google Forms survey will be posted and shared on social media platforms, such as the Oxford Brookes Business School Master's Courses Facebook page, as well as the researcher's personal social media platforms, in order to attract a large sample from the desired group of people.

A "sample" refers to the subset of the population that represents a whole group as accurately as possible (Burns et al, 2017). For this study, the desired sample is British FMCG shoppers who enjoy entertainment – due to the use of social media, this sample will mostly consist of University students; however, it is expected that some respondents will be older or younger than typical University age due to the ease of access that characterises social media/the internet.

The reason this study is attempting to attract University age students is based on a number of factors: the modern-day scepticism that younger people have of large corporations, a preference for subscription-based entertainment viewing where traditional advertising has no place, the rapid speed at which trends/interests change and evolve and their desire for authenticity. These factors make younger consumers harder to advertise to, making their thoughts/opinions on new marketing methods, such as product placement, valuable for researchers.

3.5 Quality Considerations

Primary research refers to the process of collecting and analysing original data (Clippinger, 2017). When collecting primary research, it is important to consider the level of quality, in reference to the research's reliability and validity.

Reliability refers to the extent to which a study can be repeated (Bryman and Bell, 2011); in order to be reliable, the study must be able to be redone with the same sample and same questions and produce the same or nearly the same results (Clippinger, 2017). Validity refers to the integrity of the study (Ghauri and Gronhaug, 2010), meaning that data is considered valid when providing accurate and objective information about the research topic (Clippinger, 2017).

This study can be said to be reliable as the SAS questions are asking for the participants' opinions on different product placement examples – if repeated using the same examples, it is unlikely that a participant would have changed their quantitative and qualitative opinions.

Validity will be ensured, as the study aims to understand how consumers perceive product placement, meaning the results from the SAS will be doing exactly this. The participants will also be administering the survey to themselves, so any interviewer-bias – defined as any bias arising from a skewed wording of questions (Coussement, 2011) – is avoided, ensuring objectivity.

3.6 Ethical Considerations

This study, like all research, is subject to ethical issues. In order for these ethical concerns to be managed correctly, several precautions will be taken before

participants were invited to take part, as per the Oxford Brookes University's Research Ethics code of practice (Oxford Brookes University, 2016).

Form E1 (Appendix A) will be completed, highlighting the study title, research objectives and the proposed participants. The form will also highlight if the research involves deception, financial inducements, possible psychological stress or any confidential information – this study does not involve any of this. Form E1 will be reviewed by the Oxford Brookes Faculty of Business Research, so that the study can follow the University Code of Practice on research involving human participants.

Before the participants can watch the clips and answer the survey's questions, they will have to read a participant information sheet (Appendix B) which informs them on the study's aims and why they were invited to participate. A privacy notice (Appendix C) will also be included in this study, so that the participants are told what will happen with their data and how it will be used in this research and stored by Oxford Brookes University.

Once the participants read this information, they will complete a consent form (Appendix D), agreeing to take part in the research and informing them of their right to withdraw and agreeing to the use of anonymised quotes in publications.

3.7 Data Analysis Method

Google Forms, the server in which the self-administered survey is being hosted on, has a function that summarises the responses automatically. The quantitative responses for this study, using a Likert scale, will be displayed in bar chart form. This chart will showcase the percentage of participants that chose each rating from 1-5.

The other quantitative response – the selection of which example of product placement is most-preferred – will be displayed on a pie chart showing the percentage of participants that chose each example.

The qualitative responses are simply shown in a textbox on Google Forms. The participants' written responses will be grouped and discussed based on common perceptions, for example, those who found an example 'cringey' will be quoted one after another.

The qualitative responses will also be cross-referenced with the quantitative data to see what a participant rated an example and what they had to say about it.

By cross-referencing the qualitative data with the quantitative data, as well as analysing the two sets of data separately, the research objectives will be met, and the research questions will be answered.

4. Results and Analysis

4.1. Introduction

The data from the self-administered survey revealed a series of conclusions and answers to the initial research questions which were drawn from the review on the existing product placement literature in Section 2.

As explained fully in Section 3.3, the participants were shown different clips from entertainment showcasing different types of product placement and were then asked to rate their feelings towards the placed brand(s) on a scale of 1 (negatively) to 5 (positively). They were then asked to qualitatively explain their reasons.

The results in this chapter will be separated into 5 different themes, with each type of placement acting as a theme: Obvious Product Placement, Subtle Product Placement, Comedic Product Placement, Traditional Advertising and, finally, the participant preference for either product placement or traditional advertising. Each theme will be analysed and split into a further two sections: Quantitative Results and Qualitative Results. When quoting individual participants, they will be referred to as a participant number in the following format: P1 (meaning participant 1).

4.2. Obvious Product Placement Example

Example One was an obvious and prominent use of product placement within a TV show. An obvious use of product placement, for this study and as the existing literature explained, is characterised by a verbal mention and/or physical handling of the product by the inside- entertainment characters.

Within this example of obvious product placement, a clip from *Hawaii Five-O* was shown to the participants, in which a minor character is seen eating many sandwiches from food brand, Subway, and is physically handling the product(s). This character then verbally mentions the Subway brand to the show's main characters and is discussing the advantages of buying food from Subway, such as the healthy ingredients.

This example was chosen as it is an extremely on-the-nose use of product placement that does not make an attempt to 'fit in' with the entertainment's pre-existing style which, for this example, is action-packed drama. The use of Subway

within the show also doesn't blend in with a scene, as the inclusion of Subway cuts away from the narrative to talk exclusively about the brand.

4.2.1 Quantitative Results

Example One was the least preferred example out of the three clips, with only 10.7% of participants stating the obvious use of product placement as their preferred example.

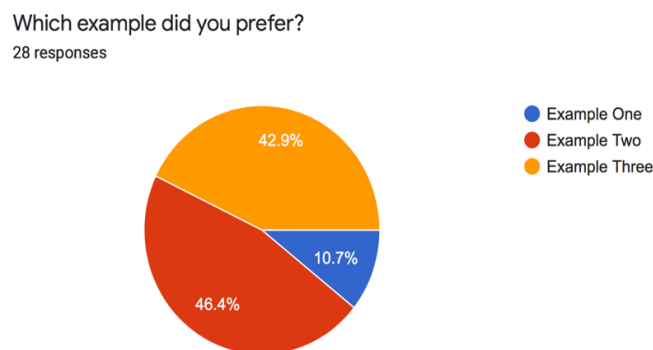


Figure 14: Study Result a

In terms of participants' feelings towards the brand advertised in Example One, which was Subway, a large number of participants rated negatively, with 39.3% choosing 2 and 10.7% choosing 1, making up 50% of the total. The other 50% rated

How do you feel towards the brand/brands advertised in Example One?
28 responses

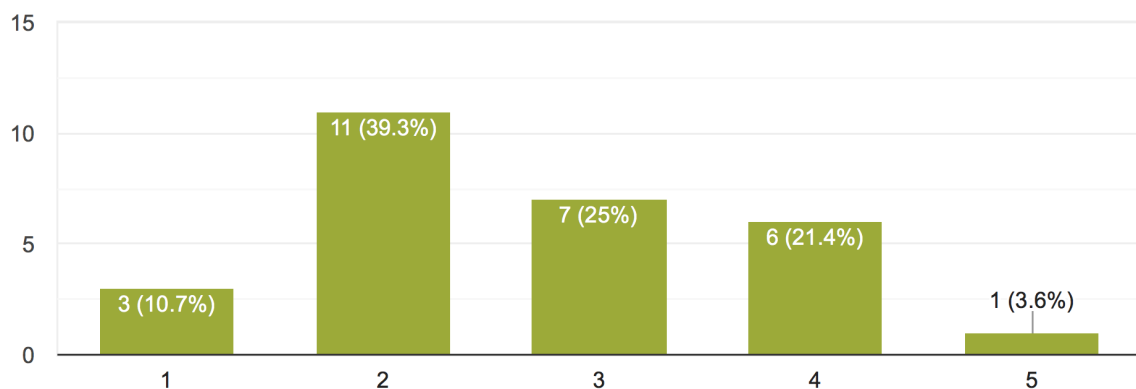


Figure 15: Study Result b

3 or higher, with 25% rating 3, 21.4% rated their feelings towards the brand as a 4 and only 3.6% rated 5. These statistics highlight that an obvious use of product placement, that makes no attempt to conform to the entertainment's pre-existing style, garners a stronger negative perception towards the brand advertised, as the 2 rating was the most popular.

In terms of participants' feelings towards the entertainment being used, the results correlate positively with their feelings towards the brand. 50% of participants rated 2 or under, with 21.4% rating a 2 and 28.6% rating a 1. The lowest 1 rating was the most popular for the entertainment, however, the distribution of answers amongst the positive ratings were higher than the brand; 17.9% rated a 5 for the entertainment, compared to the 3.6% for the brand.

This data suggests that, when used in an obvious way that doesn't fit in with the entertainment, consumers react negatively towards the brand, more so than the entertainment. However, their perception of the placed brand has an impact on their perception of the entertainment.

4.2.2 Qualitative Results

As well as rating their feelings towards the brand and the entertainment, the participants were also asked to explain their answers qualitatively. When analysing the sentiments provided by the participants through their words, many negative words and phrases can be identified:

- "Cringe and not subtle at all" (P28)
- "Too obvious that it's a placement ad" (P9)
- "It was very obvious branding, almost too much pushing it in your face" (P12)
- "The clip was so boring and was essentially an advert for subway" (P22)

P28 rated the brand as a 2 and the entertainment as a 1. P9 rated the brand as 3 and the entertainment as a 1. P12 rated both as a 2 and P22 rated the brand as a 2 and the entertainment as a 1.

These participants' explanations correlate with the quantifiable data, conveying that, for the majority of participants, an obvious use of product placement that doesn't fit in with the entertainment's style is perceived negatively by the consumers

and can be identified as too obvious and out of place. This qualitative data also highlights that, in most cases, perceptions of the brand being placed do impact perceptions of the entertainment being used.

However, there are some exceptions:

- “I enjoy the TV programme Hawaii Five-0 however I find the product placement very cringeworthy and feel a more subtle placement would be more tasteful “(P2)

Participant 2 rated the brand as 2, however, the entertainment was rated a 5, suggesting that an existing adoration for the entertainment outweighs any badly received product placement attempt. This is similar to P19:

- “I’m a fan of Subway anyway and appreciate the humour in this clip” (P19)

P19 rated both the entertainment and brand as a 5.

Whilst the majority of participants did not prefer Example One due to the product placement’s obvious style, some participants had other reasons for reacting negatively:

- “I feel I would avoid a brand that appears to endorse unhealthy behaviours. Western cultures are facing an obesity epidemic, I don’t think the advertising is appropriate” (P25)
- “Promotion of overeating and unhealthy lifestyle but also suggesting it’s acceptable” (P20)
- “Ok...fat man eating ‘subways’ plural. Not tasteful, so background paled into insignificance” (P14)
- “The brand makes connection and association with obesity” (P23)

The negative perceptions towards the brand possibly showcasing ‘unethical’ behaviours resulted in these participants rating both the brand and entertainment as 3 or under.

4.3. Subtle Product Placement

Example Two was a subtle use of product placement, one in which no characters verbally mentioned or physically handled the product.

The clip, taken from Netflix's *Stranger Things*, portrays product placement using Coca-Cola. The character is seen watching a Coca-Cola advert which then triggers a memory of her crushing the can telekinetically.

This example was chosen to be shown to participants due to how well it is integrated with the entertainment's existing style, unlike Example One. The show, *Stranger Things*, is known for its vintage and retro quality, shrouding the show with a sense of nostalgia. The brand Coca-Cola is extremely famous, and links well with this show's vintage style. The use of an old Coca-Cola advert also helps fuel the brand's integration with the entertainment.

4.3.1 Quantitative Results

Example Two was the most preferred out of the three product placement clips, with 46.4% of participants choosing it, suggesting a well-integrated brand has a more positive consumer perception than a more random choice and use of product placement.

Which example did you prefer?
28 responses

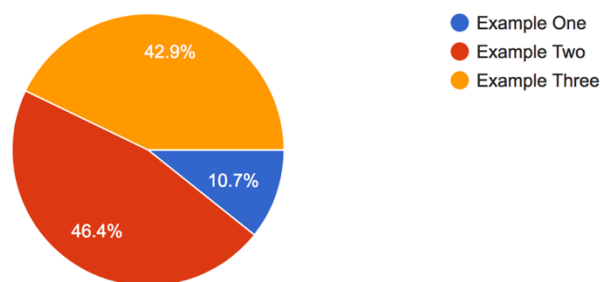


Figure 14: Study Result a (repeated)

In terms of participants' feelings towards the brand advertised in Example Two, which was Coca-Cola, the majority of participants rated positively, with 35.7% rating 3, 28.6% rating 4 and 17.9% rating a 5 – all together, 82.2% of participants rated their feelings towards the brand as 3 or above. The remaining 17.8% rated under 3.

How do you feel towards the brand/brands advertised in Example Two?

28 responses

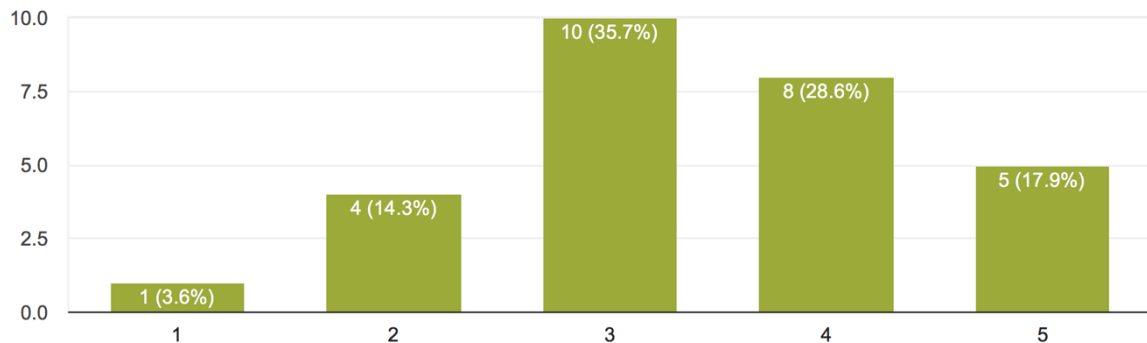


Figure 16: Study Result c

These statistics highlight that a subtle use of product placement, that attempts to conform to the entertainment's pre-existing style, garners a more positive consumer perception towards the brand being advertised.

In terms of participants' feelings towards the entertainment being used for product placement, the results correlate positively with their feelings towards the brand. 78.5% of participants rated the entertainment a 3 or higher, with 21.4% rating a 3, 32.1% rating a 4 and 25% rating a 5. Unlike the brand, where the most popular rating was a 3, the most popular rating for the entertainment was a 4 – this links with Example One, where the participants had a more positive affiliation with the entertainment, suggesting that consumers react more negatively towards the brand, even when being placed subtly.

How do you feel towards the entertainment being used in Example Two?

28 responses

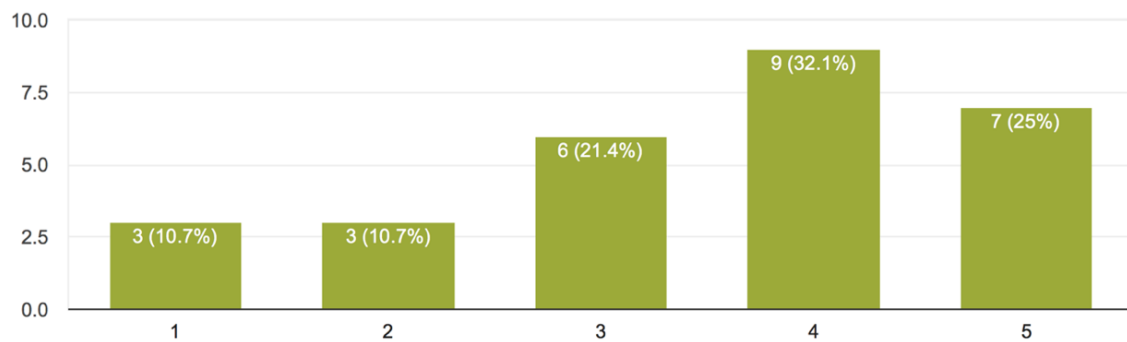


Figure 17: Study Result d

This data suggests that, when used in a subtle way that fits in with the entertainment, consumers react more positively overall, but have more negative feelings towards the brand, and positively towards the entertainment. However, their perception of the placed brand has an impact on their perception of the entertainment, with the results for brand perception and entertainment perception correlating positively.

4.3.2 Qualitative Results

The participants were also asked to explain their answers qualitatively, with their responses corroborating their quantifiable ratings. When analysing the sentiments provided through their words in relation to Example Two and its product placement, the words and phrases identified are far more positive than Example One.

The majority of the qualitative responses enjoyed the entertainment and, more interestingly, the use of product placement, with their explanations all very similar:

- “It’s much more subtle and fits well into the nature of the programme – very much prefer the nature of this product placement compared to the second” (P2)
- “The advert was era specific and done well and the show wasn’t directly advertising for coke” (P22)
- “I think it’s actually quite subtle having the coke in there, it doesn’t feel too much of an ad but rather a relatable example” (P3)
- “The placement is subtle and shows key elements of the storyline” (P21)

- “More subtle than in example one and it fits better, doesn’t feel out of place” (P10)

P2 rated the brand as a 5 and the entertainment as a 4; P22 rated the both as a 4; P3 rated both as a 4; P22 rated both as a 5; P10 rated the brand as a 3 and the entertainment as a 4.

These participants’ explanations and ratings correlate with the quantifiable data, conveying how a subtle use of product placement that conforms to the entertainment’s style garners a better consumer perception.

Similar to Example One, existing fans of the entertainment rated their feelings as positive, despite the use of product placement:

- “It may make a difference because I’ve seen this show...but this product worked a lot better here. It could’ve been any product and it would’ve had the same affect” (P4)
- “Positive because I enjoy the show, so I enjoy the product in the show” (P1)
- “Don’t like the product but was really well used in *Stranger Things*” (P28)

P4 rated the brand and entertainment as a 5; P1 rated both as a 4; and P28 rated the brand as a 2 but the entertainment as a 5.

These results suggest that existing fans of the entertainment will react positively to the product being placed as they already enjoy the entertainment; if they don’t like the product and react negatively to the placement, such as P28 who rated the brand as a 2, they will still have a positive perception of the entertainment.

It is also worth noting alternative opinions made by P12, who said:

- “As the brand was used in a tense scene I just wanted to continue watching and would have probably forgotten about the drink” (P12)

This suggests that, for some consumers, the product placement gets lost amongst the drama of the entertainment being used.

4.4. Comedic Product Placement

Example Three was a comedic use of product placement within a film. This approach to product placement can also be categorised as obvious as the products are verbally mentioned and physically handled by the film's main character. However, whilst use in an obvious way, the main point of the placement(s) is for a comedic affect, used satirically.

Within this example, a clip from *Wayne's World* was shown to the participants, which featured many different products being placed. The characters are discussing how they don't want to sell out and be sponsored by brands, and whilst talking, they are prominently showing and discussing the brands (Doritos, Pizza Hut, Reebok and more).

This example was chosen to be shown to the participants as it took a completely different approach to product placement. It was a combination of Example One and Example Two, as it was both obvious and in-your-face, but fit in with the entertainment's comedic and satirical style.

4.4.1 Quantitative Results

Which example did you prefer?
28 responses

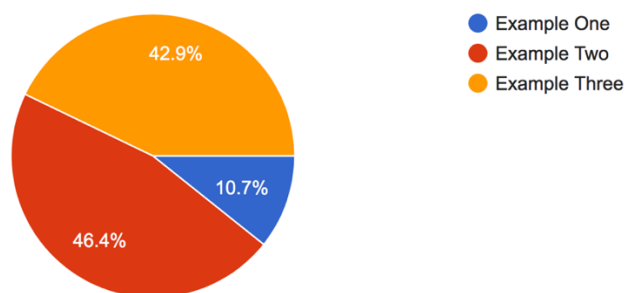


Figure 14: Study Result a (repeated)

Example Three was the second most preferred, with 42.9% of participants stating the comedic use of product placement was their preferred example.

The participants' feelings towards the brand(s) advertised in Example Three were the most positive out of the three examples; 96.4% of participants rated 3 or higher (compared to 82.2% for Example Two and 50% for Example One), with

35.7% rating a 3, 39.3% rating 4 and 21.4% rating 5. Only 3.6% rated a 2 and none of the participants rated 1.

How do you feel towards the brand/brands advertised in Example Three?

28 responses

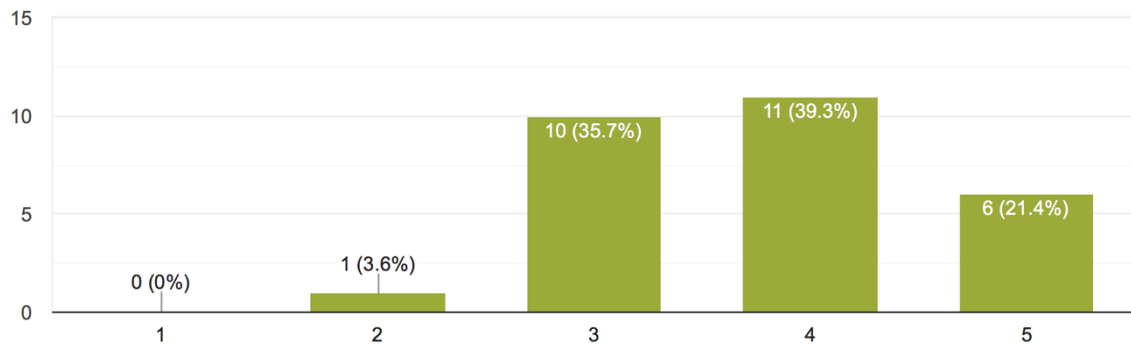


Figure 18: Study Result e

These statistics show that a comedic use of product placement leads to more positive consumer perceptions, and very little negative perceptions. The product(s) advertised are done so in an obvious way, so these perceptions contradict those from Example One as that obvious example was perceived negatively. However, Example Three's placement conforms to the entertainment's existing style with its use of comedy and satire.

The perceptions of the entertainment used in Example Three were also very positive; 85.6% of participants rated 3 or higher, with 21.4% rating a 3, 32.1% rating a 4 and 32.1% rating a 5. The remaining 14.3% rated a 2, and, again, none of the participants rated a 1. The similarity between brand perceptions of Example Three and entertainment perceptions of Example Three show that feelings towards one has an impact on the other, which corroborates the findings from Example One and Example Two.

4.4.2 Qualitative Results

After analysing the qualitative data, the sentiments provided by the participants are overwhelmingly positive. The majority of the comments revolve around the use of comedy and how it positively affected how the participants perceived both the product being placed and the entertainment being used:

- “They advertise the product well, whilst fully acknowledging the fact that they are advertising a product” (P2)
- “I really enjoyed the humour in the clip, the way they are so obvious in the film, yet it doesn’t feel like product placement because it’s so corny” (P19)
- “I liked this one because they’re laughing at themselves...product placement works as satire” (P4)

P2 rated the brands as a 4 and the entertainment as a 3; P19 rated both as a 5; and P4 rated both as a 4.

- “It is done in a comedy way which shows the brands in it can also take a joke” (P27)

This comment by P27 is interesting as it suggests that a level of self-awareness from the brands and the entertainment leads to more positive consumer perceptions. This led to P27 rating the brands and entertainment as a 5. This comment can be linked with P4.

Whilst the majority of the comments made were using positive words and phrases, a few participants differed in their opinions:

- “Too many brands all used in a similar content. No deeper emotions” (P23)
- “Context not clear...but does not seem particularly interesting” (P28)
- “I don’t really know the background of the people in this advert” (P26)

P23 rated the brands as a 3 and the entertainment as a 2; P28 rated the brands as a 3 and the entertainment as a 2; P26 rated both as a 3. These more negative results suggest that comedic product placement requires a specific sense of humour that, if not present by the consumer, leads to negative perceptions.

These qualitative responses display that a comedic use of product placement garners positive consumer perceptions from the majority of participants. This type of placement will also be perceived better when utilised in an already comedic platform, such as Example Three being used in *Wayne’s World*, a comedy. If a similar type of

product placement were to be used in a serious drama, these results suggest that it would not be as positively received by the viewers.

The less positive responses for Example Three can also draw a conclusion; comedic use of product placement relies on the consumer watching to understand the sense of humour; P28 and P26 felt the comedy was lost on them and, therefore, had a negative perception towards the products being placed and the entertainment being used.

Despite Example Three garnering the most positive response from the participants, when asked what Example of product placement they preferred, 46.4% of consumers chose Example Two.

A possible reason for this is due to Example Two's product placement being far less disruptive than Example Three. Whilst the comedic use may have made participants laugh, leading to a 42.9% consumer preference, it also completely disrupted the flow of the entertainment.

This preference for Example Two can lead to the following conclusion: product placement has higher consumer perception when it conforms to the entertainment's existing style and does not disrupt the flow of the entertainment, but instead seamlessly becomes a part of the scene.

4.5. Traditional Advertising

After being shown the three product placement examples, the participants were then shown a compilation of traditional adverts that have all been featured on UK terrestrial television. This compilation was shown to the participants to compare their perceptions of traditional advertising to their perceptions of product placement.

The participants, similar to the product placement examples, watched the clip then rated their feelings towards the brands advertised on the scale of 1 to 5. They were then asked to explain their rating using words. As there was no entertainment, it was only their perceptions towards the brands that were quantifiably and qualitatively measured.

4.5.1 Quantitative Results

How do you feel towards the brand/brands advertised in Example Four?

28 responses

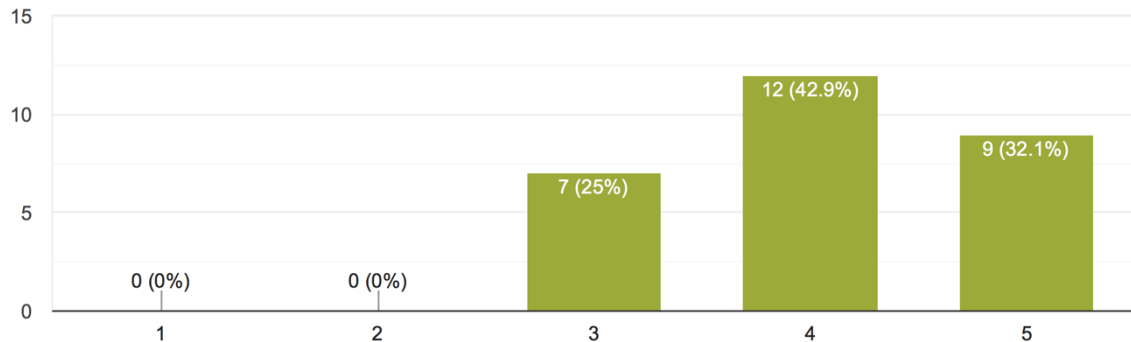


Figure 19: Study Result f

None of the participants rated a 1 or 2, suggesting only positive reactions towards the traditional advertising. 25% of participants rated a 3, 42.9% rated a 4 and 32.1% rated a 5. These results are far more positive than any of the product placement examples, which all garnered some form of negative rating.

4.5.2 Qualitative Results

The qualitative data, again, is overwhelmingly positive, with the participants explaining why the adverts are effective for them:

- “They hold your attention by using an entertainment tool like music, ref to a film” (P15)
- “Fun, clear, colourful” (P13)
- “All products are portrayed positively and with joy and happiness, so there’s no reason to feel negative towards any of the brands” (P6)
- “Positive, family related, simple and bright colours” (P1)

These descriptions highlight that the Traditional Advertising clips are being analysed on far less critical points, with simple factors such as the bright colours and fun music being yielded as positives. P15 rated the brands as 3; P13 rated a 5; P6 rated a 4; and P1 rated a 4.

- “Brands are presented in a favourable way. There is an original story of each of them, and benefits of the brands are exposed. Moreover, the brands bring positive associations with summer, holidays, family and others” (P23)

This quote is interesting, and it highlights a stark advantage of traditional advertising that product placement lacks. The company behind the brand, when using traditional advertising, are in full control of how this product is presented to an audience. With product placement, the storyline in which the brand is involved would influence how its presented, for example, in Example Two, the tense *Stranger Things* scene may affect how viewers perceived Coca-Cola. When creating an advert for TV, the company has the ability to rely purely on happy music, bright colours and optimistic images to create positive consumer perceptions.

This idea links with P6 who suggested they have “no reason to feel negative”, suggesting that product placement runs the risk of giving the viewers an opportunity to feel negatively towards the branded product.

Whilst the majority enjoyed the traditional adverts, there were responses that offered interesting insight to some consumers’ way of thinking:

- “I feel traditional advertising is much less creative than advertising through product placement” (P2)
- “Don’t really care for any of them...since I don’t necessarily watch regular TV I feel indifferent to the adverts (P10)
- “So many adverts wherever you look nowadays...that I don’t pay them much attention” (P14)
- “Fairly neutral...no real strong emotions” (P17)
- “They’re quite long adverts which is probably quite off putting” (P3)

P2 rated the brands as 3; P10 rated a 3; P14 rated a 3; P17 rated a 3; and P3 rated a 4.

This suggests that a consumer is likely to feel more indifference towards a traditional advert rather than feeling explicitly negative, highlighting that product placement garners much stronger perceptions from consumers, be that positive or

negative perceptions. Even when critical towards an advert, the lowest a consumer would rate is a 3.

4.6. 50/50 Result

After watching all the clips, the participants were finally asked to rate whether they preferred the product placement examples or the traditional advertising examples and explain why.

The reason for this question being asked was to reach an ultimate conclusion as to what the participants preferred and had more positive perceptions of. It was also asked to garner a more holistic understanding of how the participants felt towards product placement in general. Whilst the other results can be used to determine this, and to draw many other conclusions that answer the research questions, this result would've been useful to have.

Overall, did you prefer the product placement examples or traditional advertising examples?
28 responses

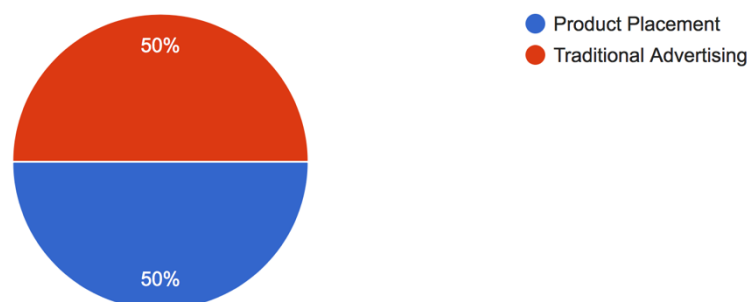


Figure 20: Study Result g

However, asking this question resulted in a 50/50 split, with half of the participants preferring product placement, and the other half preferring traditional advertising. Whilst this result doesn't suggest a conclusion, the participants' qualitative explanations reveal a lot.

- "You expect to see traditional advertising when you watch television...However, when you are consuming content, you didn't necessarily subscribe to being advertised to" (P5)

P5 preferred Traditional Advertising due to its inherent transparency. P5 also added their thoughts on product placement:

- “It can also break the immersion, or the suspension of disbelief, and affects the experience of consuming content. Sometimes product placement can be done with humour...although it is still a form of advertising you didn’t expect to be there” (P5)

This highlights that product placement, such as the obvious instances in Example One and Example Three, can be deemed too disruptive for some consumers. The lack of transparency with product placement, if attempted to be subtle such as Example Two, can be perceived as deceptive.

This links with P12 who also preferred traditional advertising:

- “You know what you’re getting with the advert and you’re not distracted by anything else” (P12)

P12’s comments suggest that consumers dislike product placement as they find it distracting to their content, whereas they expect to see traditional advertising, so it isn’t jarring to their viewing experience.

The idea of product placement negatively affecting the experience of consuming content was echoed by P19:

- “With product placement you are compelled to watch...whereas with adverts you can skip / choose to watch without detriment” (P19)

This highlights that this consumer would rather be able to skip adverts than have to watched content featuring branded products, suggesting that, for some consumers, any form of advertising is deemed detrimental.

Another reason used to support traditional advertising over product placement, is that the latter tool can be perceived as unethical:

- “The product placement of items is a sneaky way for brands to try and get more sales...Very sneaky. So at least with adverts on TV they are straight up with you” (P6)

Whilst the qualitative results from Section 4.4.2, showcased that obvious product placements are perceived better when used comedically, participants still highlighted that the lack of subtly as a reason for preferring Traditional Advertising:

- “Some product placement seems glaringly obvious and forced whereas adverts are far more natural” (P21)
- [Traditional Advertising] “didn’t get in the way or dilute the quality of the show I was watching” (P22)
- “Product placement feels forced and detracts from the storylines” (P18)

The point made in Section 4.5.2 by P6 who claimed that Traditional Advertising doesn’t give you a reason to feel negatively was echoed when preferences were being discussed:

- “Traditional Advertising is more fun and is less likely to have negative associations. Product placement can be really creative but it’s easier to get it wrong” (P25)

The other 50% of participants preferred product placement:

- “I prefer product placement because it’s a lot more subtle. Also, if you aren’t paying attention to the ad part, you can still enjoy the story line or the sketch that goes with it” (P3)

This highlights an advantage of product placement, in that the very nature of the advertisement is entertaining; if the consumer is watching the content, it’s because they find it enjoyable, hence the branded product is being advertised to a consumer who is already feeling positive. P3 went to say:

- “With traditional advertising, it can be dull and very specific, and although they can be funny and entertaining, they are less enjoyable to watch” (P3)

The links with P2, who said:

- “I find product placement to be much more enticing and creative” (P2)

WARC (2019b) highlighted its inability to be skipped or edited out as a strong advantage that product placement has over traditional advertising. This point is corroborated by the participants’ qualitative opinions:

- “Most traditional adverts lose my attention, and I skip them whenever I can” (P2)
- “I prefer product placement because I’m consuming entertainment as the product is being promoted...I find traditional ads repetitive and become blind to them” (P4)
- “I do not watch a lot of TV so ads get lost in the noise. With product placement I will enjoy the show and my brain will register the product without even knowing” (P1)

P1’s opinion about not watching television is becoming more and more common; as discussed in Section 2.2.2 of the Literature Review, 6 in 10 people now consume content through a streaming service rather than television, with this figure reaching almost 9 in 10 amongst consumers aged 16-24 (Intel, 2019b).

- “I find some traditional adverts ‘messy’ or too long. I like simple, relevant adverts that focus your attention on one thing” (P14)
- “More subtle and interesting way to advertise, may be more subconsciously memorable than traditional advertising” (P17)
- “More memorable and can reach a wider range of people” (P27)

Not only do these participants prefer product placement, but their comments suggest that they believe that traditional advertising is bad practice, noting that it isn't memorable and can be cluttered.

The participants also noted how attributes from the entertainment helps make product placement more affective:

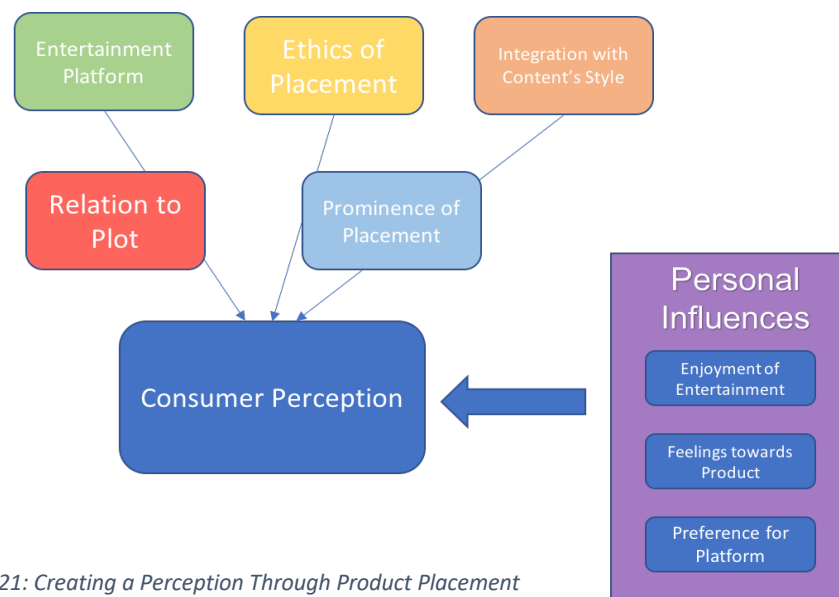
- “You get more of a story” (P13)
- “It was nicer to see a familiar face that I recognised” (P26)
- “Being humorous goes a long way” (P20)

4.7 Creating a Perception Through Product Placement Model

After analysing the results from this study, a model has been created, Figure 21, that illustrates the different ways in which a perception of product placement is made in the eyes of the consumer (Author, 2020).

This model was built using the existing research from Section 2.3, as well as new findings presented in Sections 4.2 – 4.6. Five factors, controlled by the product company and/or the entertainment network include: the entertainment platform used, such as streaming service, terrestrial television, programme or film; the ethics of the placement; the prominence of the placement (obvious/subtle); the level to which the placement is related to the plot of the entertainment; and if the product placement is well-integrated with the entertainment content's style.

However, there are also factors that are beyond the control of the marketers and the entertainment network. The consumers' personal influences – their enjoyment of the entertainment, their feelings towards the placed product and their preference of entertainment platforms – has an impact on their perceptions of the product placement.



*Figure 21: Creating a Perception Through Product Placement
(Author, 2020)*

This model also insinuates how a product placement can create a positive perception: target your audience via the group's preferred entertainment platform; make the placement ethical, by not placing ethically-charged products in ethically-charged contexts; integrate the product well with the content's style; relate the placement to the plot – if this is all done well, then the prominence of the placement (Obvious/Subtle) accentuates the positive perception.

5. Discussion

5.1 Introduction

Consumer attitudes towards product placement has been researched, being reviewed in Section 2.4.1, and found key insights into product placement's effectiveness on brand recognition and brand recall. Other areas that existing research had investigated was the categorisation of placements (2.4.2), which found different modes of presentation for product placement: prominent, serendipitous, opportunistic and planned placements. The current innovations (2.4.3) of product placement have also been researched, with specific technological advancements highlighted that are likely to impact the market.

However, an area that had not been fully realised was consumer perceptions of product placement, and how the different categorisation approaches influences these perceptions. With this new research, the conversation surrounding consumer perceptions of product placement has been charged, with supportive quantitative and qualitative data to solidify the results.

This section aims to combine the literature with this study's findings to further discuss the results and construct a coherent discussion of consumer perceptions of product placement.

5.2. Product Placement Preferences

The literature on consumer attitudes of product placement, discussed in Section 2.4.1, highlights many different ways in which consumers more organically consume product placement. The research from this study also found many ways in consumers organically consume content. These different ways can be labelled as "preferences".

5.2.1 Plot-Related

d'Astous and Chartier (2000) found that viewers recognised the branded product being placed far more when appearing alongside the leading actor/actress. This can be linked with Redondo (2006), Johnstone and Dodd (2000) and Brennan et al (1999) who, in their research, found that plot-related product placements were more effective.

These results corroborate with this study's findings, as consumers had more positive perceptions of the branded product and of the entertainment when one was seamlessly integrated the other (Sections 4.3 and 4.4). With Example Two, the branded product, Coca-Cola, was placed into *Stranger Things* and fit in with the content's style and with the storyline. 82.2% of participants rated their feelings for the brand as 3 or higher on a scale of 1 (negatively) to 5 (positively).

In Example Four, the branded products included Pizza Hut, Pepsi, Reebok and Doritos, and were all comedically integrated into *Wayne's World*. The comedic use of the brands fit in with the content's comedy genre, and had 96.4% of participants rate a 3 or higher for the brand.

Redondo (2006) also corroborates these findings, with their study highlighting that the targeting accuracy of product placement is significantly higher when placements are closely connected to the entertainment's plot.

5.2.2 Enjoyment of the Entertainment

Johnstone and Dodd (2000) found, in their research, that participants who liked the entertainment had high levels of brand recall compared to those who did not like the entertainment. Similarly, this study found that participants who liked the entertainment also had positive perceptions of the placed product. In Section 4.3.2, where the qualitative results of the Subtle Product Placement were discussed, those participants who noted their existing adoration for the entertainment also tended to rate the placed brand as 4 or above.

This finding of an enjoyment of the entertainment impacting perceptions of the brand was corroborated by Redondo (2006), whose study into product placement planning stated that the effectiveness of product placement heavily relies on the relationship between placement and entertainment.

5.2.3 Ethical

Gupta and Gould's (1997) research discussed the idea of ethically-charged products such as alcohol, cigarettes and guns. However, the results from Example One of this study suggest that ethically-charged products rely on more than the product itself. Example One featured a man, large in weight, eating Subway sandwiches and was

featured in the TV show, *Hawaii Five-0*. The weight of the man, along with the branded food product, resulted in participants rating both brand and entertainment negatively; 50% of participants rated 2 or under for the brand, 50% rating 2 or under for the entertainment.

The qualitative data for Example One, outlined in Section 4.2.2, pinpoints the overweight character as the reason for perceiving the product placement negatively, due to the opinion that the entertainment and brand are promoting obesity.

This data aligns with Gupta and Gould's (1997) idea of specific products being ethically-charged, however, these new findings indicate that the product's place within the entertainment (including the context and the character using the product) should also be considered as possibly ethically-charged.

5.2.4 Well-Integrated

Thinkbox's (2015a) research findings are closely related to those of this study, as Thinkbox found that brand and entertainment fit is important in order for the viewer to deem the placement as acceptable. If the placement is forced and does not fit in with the style of the entertainment, then it will be rejected (Thinkbox, 2015a).

The findings of this research strongly support Thinkbox's (2015a). The first example of product placement that was shown to participants was an Obvious example that did not fit in with the entertainment's pre-existing style. This resulted in the example being the least preferred example out of the three, with only 10.7% of participants choosing it as their favourite (Section 4.2.1). The qualitative results for this, outlined in Section 4.2.2, indicate that the majority of participants found the placement to be too obvious, 'cringe-worthy' and difficult to enjoy.

Example Two was the most preferred example out of the three product placement clips, with 46.4% of participants choosing it as their favourite example. Based on the qualitative responses given, displayed in Section 4.3.2, this is due to integration of the branded product into the entertainment. The show, *Stranger Things*, is famed for its vintage production style, with flairs of the 80s sprinkled throughout the content. The show's placement of Coca-Cola fit in with this vintage style, by utilising an old advert of the soft drink, before having one of the main characters subtly interact with the product.

The third example was obvious yet was well-integrated with the style of the entertainment, garnering a participant preference of 42.9%. The comedic use of product placement fit in with comedy genre of the entertainment, corroborating the Thinkbox (2015a) results.

5.2.5 New Findings

Whilst some of the findings of this study can be corroborated by the existing literature that touches upon consumer attitudes, as discussed in Section 2.4.1, there were some new findings that help marketers further understand consumer perceptions of product placement.

Whilst Johnstone and Dodd's (2000) and Redondo's (2006) research conveys that an enjoyment of the entertainment has a strong connection to brand recall, this new research contributes further understanding. An existing enjoyment of the entertainment, but strong dislike of the placed product, will not affect that consumer's experience of the entertainment. Some participants rated the placed product negatively, however they rated the entertainment positively, such as P28 who rated the brand from Example Two as a 2, but the entertainment as a 5 – in their qualitative explanation, P28 noted they were a fan of the entertainment prior to taking part in the study.

This study also found that comedic product placements garner more positive perceptions from consumers compared to more serious placements. Whilst Example Two – which was not comedic – was the most preferred example, with 46.4% of participants choosing it as their favourite, it was Example Three's brands and entertainment that were rated the highest.

Even if obvious and rather pushy, if the comedic placements fit in with the style of the entertainment, then consumers will have the highest perceptions, quantitatively and qualitatively, as highlighted by Example Three's results (Section 4.4).

Another new finding is that consumers have higher standards of product placement than they do of traditional advertising. The results for traditional advertising, outlined in Section 4.5, accentuates the lower standards. Consumers praised them based on superficial criteria such as the bright colours and upbeat

music. Whereas, the product placements were rated against the same criteria as entertainment content, such as storyline, production value and standard of acting.

A model has also been created, and is presented in Section 4.7, which showcases the different factors that help create a consumer perception via product placement.

5.3 Product Placement Categorisation

As well as consumer attitudes, the literature reviewed in Section 2.4.2 also explored how product placements can be categorised. Chang et al's (2009) research into product placement categorisation took an industry-focused approach, detailing the different ways in which products become placements in entertainment content.

These different industry-focused ways include: serendipitous placements, whereby products are chosen to be placed simply to fill a prop-space on set; opportunistic placements, which is when a script is scanned by an agency to uncover placement opportunities; and planned placements, where an entertainment network has a contractual agreement to work exclusively with a company in order to place their branded products (Chang et al, 2009).

Whilst this contributes to a layman's understanding of the advertising tool, there are other ways by which consumers categorise product placement they watch be imbedded in their entertainment content.

The literature and the findings from this study agree that the idea of obvious, or 'prominent', placements is an appropriate categorisation approach. Gupta and Lord (1998) described prominence as the physical size and position on the screen, as well as its vitality to the action of the entertainment. This very well describes how Obvious was used for this study. Redondo (2006), Johnstone and Dodd (2000) and Brennan et al (1999) explored prominent placements, as did older research into print ad prominence by Finn (1988) and Engel et al (1993).

The literature reviewed in Section 2.4.2 explores how effective prominence placements were in terms of brand recall, whilst this study explored how Obvious and Subtle placements impacted consumer perception. This means that this study contributed more research to the topic, expanding on the existing research of the Obvious/Subtle categorisation approach, previously explored by Gupta and Lord (1998), Johnstone and Dodd (2000) and Brennan et al (1999).

6. Conclusion

6.1 Research Aims, Objectives and Questions

The purpose of this study was to understand the perceptions of product placement, within the entertainment industry, through the eyes of the consumers of the United Kingdom. By reviewing the previous research in this area, this dissertation has determined the main ways in which consumers prefer their product placement, and how marketers can create positive consumer perceptions with their use of product placement.



Figure 3: Research Objectives (repeated) (Author, 2020)

6.1.1 Objective 1

The first objective of this study was to determine if consumers find product placement within entertainment to be an authentic form of advertising. However, as the research developed and the results were analysed, this objective became less focal; the growth of technologies within entertainment and changing consumer habits has resulted in an increase of product placement, especially within streaming, so consumers' opinions of its authenticity has little impact on the market as a whole.

6.1.2 Objective 2

The second objective of understanding how consumers feel towards a brand after witnessing its product placement was met via the mixed-methods research approach. The quantitative and qualitative data fuelled the understanding that consumers' perceptions of the placed brand are influenced by how it is placed, and its relationship with the entertainment (Section 4.2 – 4.4).

An obvious placement that does not fit in with the entertainment's style will cause the consumers to hold negative perceptions towards the brand, as highlighted in Section 4.2. If the placement is unrelated to the plot, the data suggests that consumers will lack strong feeling and, ultimately, rate the brand negatively.

If obvious but in-keeping with the style of the content, then consumers will perceive the brand positively. Subtle placements also are more likely to result in positive perceptions, with the placement's integration with the content and plot less influential, as outlined in Section 4.3.

Less serious and more comedic placements are also more likely to lead to positive perceptions of the placed brand, as the results in Section 4.4 insinuate.

6.1.3 Objective 3 and Objective 4

The third and fourth objective were to discover whether the product placement impacts how the consumer perceives the entertainment, and vice-versa.

As the results for the three product placements examples indicate in Section 4.2 – 4.4, positive perceptions of one leads to positive perceptions of the other. For example, an enjoyment of the entertainment content will create a positive perception of the branded product being placed, as Example Two showcased due to a large number of participants being existing fans of *Stranger Things*.

Similarly, an enjoyment of the branded product creates positive perceptions of the entertainment, such as Example One, where fans of Subway rated their feelings as 5 for both brand and entertainment, despite the product placement being badly integrated and unrelated to the plot.

6.1.4 Research Questions

The research questions (Figure 7) were also answered by the mixed-methods approach. Q1, as discussed in Section 6.1.1, was found to be unimpactful to the overall conclusions of this research. For Q2, it was found that consumers prefer product placement that, ultimately, is well-integrated with the style of the entertainment content. The use of comedy when placing a branded product also helps the consumer build a positive perception, as per the results outlined in Section 4.4, due to the happiness associated with laughing. The comedy helps perceive the brand as 'in on the joke', making the placement seem less focused on selling a product, and more focused on contributing to the humour in the eyes of the consumer.

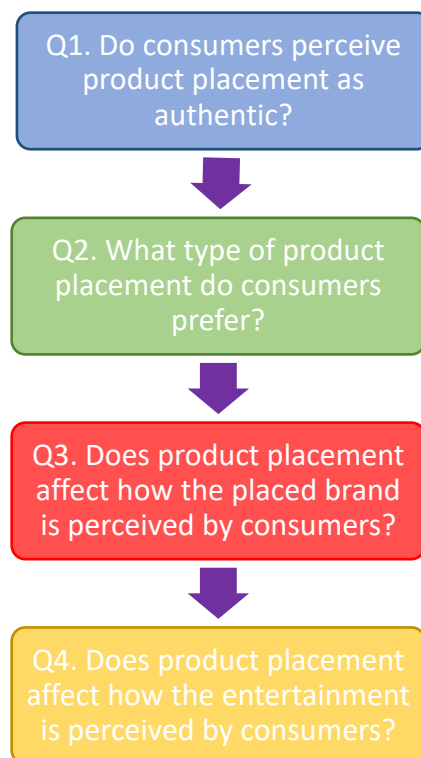


Figure 7: Research Questions (repeated) (Author, 2020)

The research answered Q3 and Q4; the product placement impacts how the consumer perceives the brand, as the Obvious placements led to negative perceptions, both quantitatively and qualitatively, of the brand and of the entertainment, as discussed in Section 4.2.

6.2 Contributions of the Study

The following points have contributed to existing knowledge, and could be applied to future studies into consumer perceptions of product placement

1. The primary research has led to the formation of a model that outlines how to create a consumer perception through the use of product placement. This model is presented in Figure 21 in Section 4.7, and can be used to identify the different factors that lead to positive consumer perceptions of product placement.
2. This new research has proven that changing habits of consuming content has led to a change in how consumers view advertising efforts by companies. The increase of on-demand viewing, fuelled by SVOD platforms and streaming services, has led to consumers being overly critical of advertisements, meaning brands have to be careful about creating positive perceptions of their placed products.
3. The data provided by this study has highlighted that there is a direct relationship between the product being placed and the entertainment being used. This information can be used in future product placement efforts, such as the innovative new methods of AI-driven placements.
4. This study has provided an extensive understanding of how different types of placements (Obvious, Subtle and Comedic) influence the perceptions of consumers. This research can be used by marketers/entertainment networks to understand what type of placement is best utilised for a specific product or specific content.

6.3 Marketing Implications

As well as academic contributions, the study and its results also have practical industry implications that can be labelled as valuable and beneficial for marketers. In the literature review, in Section 2.4.3, current innovations of product placement were

discussed; AI-driven programmatic placements are being created, meaning that the placed products will become interchangeable based upon the individual watching (WARC, 2020b), making the placement fully targeted and completely personal. The results presented in Section 4, as well as the contributions in Section 6.2, this study has revealed detailed insight into the relationship between placements and entertainment. This information is useful when crafting the interchangeable placements, as marketers and entertainment networks have the digital capabilities as well as this knowledge on creating positive perceptions via product placement. This means that the ultimate positive perception can be created.

Figure 21 showcases a model that can be used to develop product placements perceptions, and has been discussed throughout this dissertation in Sections 4.7 and 6.2.

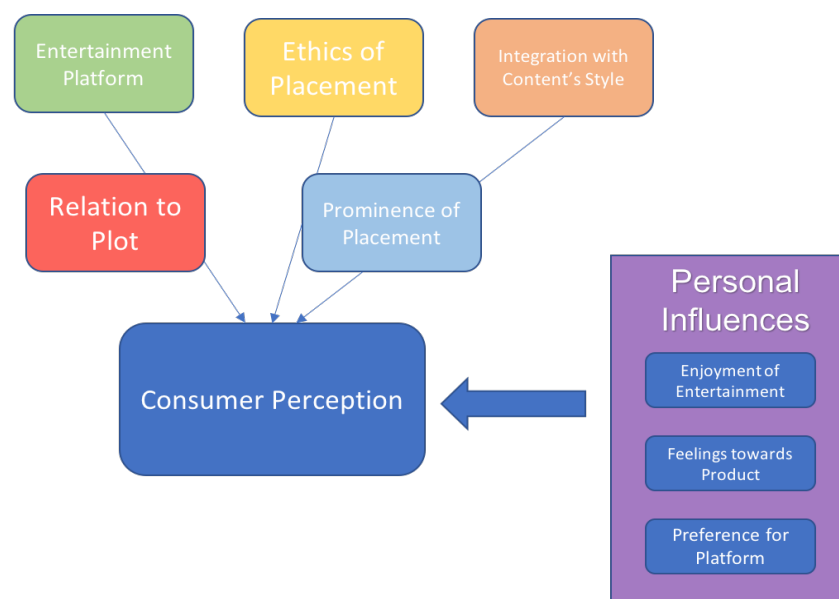


Figure 21: Creating a Perception Through Product Placement (repeated) (Author, 2020)

The model can be utilised by marketers to understand how to create a positive perception via product placement, and was created using existing academic research as well as the new findings from this study. What this has contributed to marketing is a base model to be used and built upon. By considering the five factors (Entertainment Platform, Ethics, Integration with Style, Relation to Plot and the Prominence of Placement), a marketer/entertainment network can critically review their use of product placement. This model also considers Personal Influences, which includes the consumer's preference for platform, as, nowadays, streaming

services are the more common form of entertainment consumption (Section 2.2). By considering the consumer's platform preference, this model helps marketers attempting to use terrestrial television or cinema-based productions in the age of streaming; these marketers can observe the "preference for platform" and conduct their own research to see if their target audience would be watching TV or attending the cinema as their preferred platform for entertainment consumption.

6.4 Limitations of the Study

When analysing and presenting the results of this study in Section 4, different limitations were realised. The main limitation relates to the existing literature and the lack of new research into product placement, specifically consumer perceptions/attitudes towards the advertising tool. This resulted in the literature exploring consumer attitudes, in Section 2.4.1, to be from very out-dated sources. This is a stark limitation as modern ways of consuming entertainment are not researched at all in the literature review, in regard to its impact on product placement. This means that the study was not undertaken with a holistic understanding of today's consumer attitudes towards product placement, as recent research into this area is lax.

Another limitation of the study that was overlooked is the even number of participants. Whilst planning the methodology of this research, there was not a specific number of participants set as an aim, which resulted in this study accepting 28 responses. This is an ideal number as it provides enough quantitative and qualitative data to draw generalisable conclusions, however, it is an even number

Overall, did you prefer the product placement examples or traditional advertising examples?
28 responses

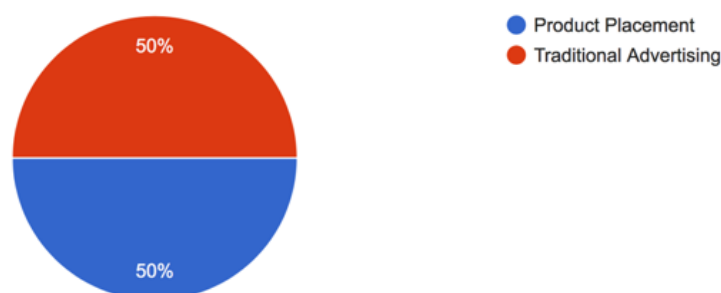


Figure: 20 Study Result
g (repeated)

which led to a 50/50 result, as outlined in Section 4.6, when the participants were asked if they preferred product placement or traditional advertising.

Whilst the qualitative data for this preference question provided detailed insight, which was used to draw conclusions, quantitatively this question can be described as inconclusive.

By using a self-administered survey, there is no opportunity to ask unplanned questions in order to clarify a response given by the participant. For example, when explaining the quantitative rating, some answers are unclear, and the meaning is lost. If a different data collection method was utilised, such as un-structured interview (Greenfield and Greener, 2016), then additional questions, as well as the pre-written questions, could be put to the participant in order to further the researcher's understanding of consumer perceptions.

6.5 Future Research

Whilst this new study has filled several research gaps that existing literature left empty, there are few areas that can be suggested for future research.

A first suggestion for future research is the use of interviews in a similar study, to understand even more holistically how consumers perceive different types of product placement. As discussed in Section 6.4, the use of a self-administered survey has certain limitations such as the lack of further explanation of respondents' answers. Future research using interviews would not have this as a limitation.

Another suggestion for future research is a study utilising the model presented in Sections 4.7 and 6.3; this model outlines the factors that are used to create a consumer perception of product placement. Future research could use this model to investigate each factor (Entertainment Platform, Ethics, Integration with Content's Style, Relation to Plot and the Prominence of the Placement) to determine the relationship between each, as well as the importance of each in creating a consumer perception.

This model could also be used to investigate, deeper, how streaming is shaping consumer perceptions of product placement. As the model considers Personal Influences, which includes the preferred way of consuming content, future research could compare how these factors influence perceptions of placements on streaming services and placements on terrestrial channels.

6.6 Concluding Thoughts

After exploring this study, it is evident that a valid contribution to the understanding of product placement has been made. This research has expanded the conversation on the method of advertising, and has enabled a holistic understanding of the different factors that lead to the creation of positive or negative perceptions in the eyes of the consumer. It is hoped that this research will serve as a link between consumers and marketers, by providing beneficial information that can be utilised in marketing decision making.

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Appendix

Appendix A:

Form E1



Ethical review form for Faculty of Business Research

Students and staff members are required to observe the highest ethical standards when undertaking research. The Faculty of Business requires both students and staff undertaking research to comply with the [University Code of Practice Involving Human Participants](#). The checklist below is intended to help you reflect on possible issues of ethical concern arising from your proposed programme of research. All students must attach the completed checklist to dissertations, theses, projects and relevant course work.

1. Working Title of Proposed Research

Consumer Perceptions of Product Placement in the United Kingdom's Entertainment Industry

2. Broad Research Objectives

To determine if consumers find product placement within entertainment to be an authentic form of advertising; to discover how consumers feel towards a brand after witnessing its product placement; to discover whether the product placement impacts how the consumer perceives the entertainment; to discover whether the entertainment impacts how the consumer perceives the product placement.

3. Who are your proposed research participants?

The research will be using participants belonging to Generation Z, who will be targeted through river sampling by posting the invite to the survey on student pages.

4. How are you going to gather data from these participants?

Through an online self-administered survey.

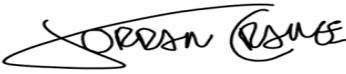
5. Does your proposed research involve any of the following:

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------|
| • Deception of participants? | Yes/No |
| • Financial inducements? | Yes/No |
| • Possible psychological stress? | Yes/No |
| • Access to confidential information? | Yes/No |
| • Any other special circumstances? | Yes/No |

6. If you have answered "yes" to any of question 5, how will you deal with these issues?

N/A

7. I have read and understood the [University Code of Practice on research involving human participants](#)

Name: Jordan Crane Signature: 

In my view, the student has considered the ethical issues involved in this piece of work

Name of tutor: _____ Signature: _____

Appendix B:

Participant Information Sheet

Study Title

Consumer Perceptions of Product Placement in the United Kingdom's Entertainment Industry

Invitation Paragraph

You are being asked to take part in a research study, exploring consumer perceptions of product placement in the United Kingdom's entertainment industry.

Who has reviewed the study?

I am conducting this research as a MSc Marketing and Brand Management student of Oxford Brookes University. This research has been approved by the University Research Ethics Committee.

Contact for further information?

If you have any concerns about the way in which the study has been conducted, you should contact the Chair of the University Research Ethics Committee on ethics@brookes.ac.uk.

Before you decide whether or not take part, it is important to understand why this study is being conducted and what will be involved. Please read the following information carefully.

Why have I been invited to participate?

You have been asked to participate as you belong to a demographic that is hard to advertise to, due to a preference for streaming platforms, a scepticism towards large corporations and quick changing trends. Being hard to advertise to makes your opinion important.

What is the purpose of the study?

The purpose of this study is to establish how consumers, like you, feel towards product placement (if you aren't sure what this means, do not worry!). You will be shown a collection of clips that feature product placement. You will then be asked survey-styled questions to garner a clear understanding of your thoughts/opinions.

The process should take 15 minutes in total.

Do I have to take part?

It is up to you to decide whether or not to take part in this study. If you do decide to take part you will be given this information sheet along with a privacy notice that will explain how your data will be collected and used and be asked to give your consent. If you decide to take part, you are free to withdraw at any time and without reason.

Will what I say in this study be kept confidential?

All information collected will be kept strictly confidential (subject to legal limitations). Your identity will be hidden in the collection, storage and publication of this research. The data generated in this course of this research must be kept securely in paper or electronic form for a period of ten years after the completion of the research project, for University staff and Doctoral students only.

Thank you for taking the time to read this participant information sheet.

Appendix C:

Privacy Notice for Research Objectives

This privacy notice provides information on how Oxford Brookes University collects and uses your personal information when you take part in one of our research projects. Please refer to the research participant information sheet for further details about the study and what information will be collected about you and how it will be used.

Oxford Brookes University (OBU) will usually be the Data Controller of any data that you supply for this research. This means that we are responsible for looking after your information and using it properly. The exception to this is joint research projects where you would be informed on the participant information sheet as to the other partner institution or institutions. This means that they will make the decisions on how your data is used and for what reasons. You can contact the University's Information Management Team on 01865 485420 or email info.sec@brookes.ac.uk.

Why do we need your data?

The purpose of this research is to understand consumer perceptions of product placement within the Entertainment industry. Your data will help researchers further their knowledge on this topic, and how efficient current practices are.

OBUs legal basis for collecting this data is

- You have given OBU explicit consent to do so

What type of data will OBU use?

This study is collecting consumer's opinions, thoughts and attitudes towards product placement within the entertainment industry. This information will be collected through a self-administered survey. This study **will not** be asking for sensitive information such as political opinions, religious beliefs, health or sexual status, genetic data, criminal records or racial/ethnic origin.

Who will OBU share your data with?

There **are not** any partner institutions or research collaborators who will have access to this data. The study will be conducted through a self-administered survey through a third-party processor who will host the survey. Based on your own cookie preferences, these third-party processors may have access to the data you provide.

Will OBU transfer my data outside of the UK?

No.

What rights do I have regarding my data that OBU holds?

- You have the right to be informed about what data will be collected and how this will be used
- You have the right of access to your data
- You have the right to correct data if it is wrong
- You have the right to ask for your data to be deleted
- You have the right to restrict use of the data we hold about you
- You have the right to data portability
- You have the right to object to the university using your data
- You have rights in relation to using your data in automated decision making and profiling.

Where did OBU source my data from?

The data is coming from willing participants.

Are there any consequences of not providing the requested data?

There are no consequences of not providing data for this research. It is purely coincidental.

Will there be any automated decision making using my data?

There will be no use of automated decision making in scope of UK Data Protection and Privacy Legislation.

How long will OBU keep your data?

In line with Oxford Brookes policies data generated in the course of research must be kept securely in paper or electronic form for a period of time in accordance with the research funder or University policy.

Who can I contact if I have concerns?

In the event of any questions about the research study, please contact the researchers in the first instance (contact details in the study participant information sheet). If you have any concerns about the way in which the study has been conducted, contact the Chair of the University Research Ethics Committee at ethics@brookes.ac.uk. For further details about the information security contact the Data Protection Officer at: brookesdpo@brookes.ac.uk or the Information Management team on info.sec@brookes.ac.uk.

Appendix D:



CONSENT FORM

Full title of Project: Consumer Perceptions of Product Placement in the United Kingdom's Entertainment Industry

Researcher Contact Information: Jordan Crane, 07854647874, 19015797@brookes.ac.uk

Please initial box

1. I confirm that I have read and understand the information sheet for the above study and have had the opportunity to ask questions.
2. I understand that my participation is voluntary and that I am free to withdraw at any time, without giving reason.
3. I agree to take part in the above study.
4. I agree to the use of anonymised quotes in publications
5. I agree that an anonymised data set, gathered for this study may be stored in a specialist data centre/repository relevant to this subject area for future research

☐
☐
☐
☐
☐

Name of Participant

Date

Signature

Name of Researcher

Date

Signature